IELTS ACADEMIC READING

Volume 6

6 complete Academic Reading tests — three full passages and 40 questions each — with a complete answer key and passage evidence for every answer

IB

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6	240	Full
FULL TESTS	QUESTIONS	ANSWER KEY

Created by Teacher: Ibodullaev Bekhruz

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Introduction

Welcome to **IELTS Academic Reading — Volume 6**, a printable practice book of 6 complete Reading tests, compiled and prepared by Teacher Ibodullaev Bekhruz.

Every test follows the real exam format: three passages of increasing difficulty and 40 questions covering the full range of IELTS question types — True/False/Not Given, Matching Headings, Matching Information, Multiple Choice, Summary and Sentence Completion, and more. Answer circles and blank lines are left for you to write your answers, just like on test day.

Part One contains all 6 tests with questions only, so you can practise without seeing any answers. **Part Two** contains the complete Answer Key for each test, with the keywords from each question and the exact sentence in the passage that proves the correct answer.

How to use this book:

- Sit each test in one go, under timed conditions — 60 minutes for all three passages.
- Write your answers directly in the circles and blanks provided.
- Check your answers in Part Two and read the passage evidence for every question you got wrong.
- Use the band-score table on the answer key pages to estimate your result, then revisit weak question types.

Good luck with your preparation, and follow **@bekhruzposts** for more free IELTS materials.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 1

Volume 6 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Mungo Lady and Mungo Man

Controversies in Australian Prehistory

Fifty thousand years ago, a lush landscape greeted the first Australians moving towards the south-east of the continent. Temperatures were cooler than now. Megafauna – giant prehistoric animals such as marsupial lions and the rhinoceros-sized diprotodon – were abundant. Freshwater lakes in areas of western New South Wales (NSW) were brimming with fish. But change was coming. By 40,000 years ago, water levels had started to drop.

A study of the sediments and graves of Lake Mungo, a dry lake bed in western NSW, has uncovered the muddy layers deposited as the lake began to dry up. Forty thousand years ago, families took refuge at the lake from the encroaching desert, leaving artefacts such as stone tools, which researchers used to determine that the first wanderers came to the area between 46,000 and 50,000 years ago. By 20,000 years ago, the lake had become the dry, dusty hole it is today. This area was first examined by the University of Melbourne geologist Professor Jim Bowler in 1969. He was searching for ancient lakes and came across the remains of a woman who had been buried with some ceremony; she was given the name Mungo Lady. In 1974, he found a second set of remains, Mungo Man, buried 300 metres away. Bowler's comprehensive study of different sediment layers has concluded that both graves are 40,000 years old.

This is much younger than the 62,000 years Mungo Man was attributed with in 1999 by a team led by Professor Alan Thorne, of the Australian National University. Thorne is the country's leading opponent of the 'Out of Africa' theory – that modern humans spread around the globe from Africa about 100,000 years ago. The revision of Mungo Man's age has refocused attention on academic disputes about mankind's origins.

The arrival date of these early Australians is linked to another vexed question: the reason for the disappearance of the megafauna. Dr Tim Flannery, a proponent of the controversial theory that these animals were wiped out by the extreme hunting practices of humans, claims that the new Mungo dates support this view. For Bowler, however, these debates are speculative distractions. At 40,000 years old, he argues, Mungo Man and Mungo Lady remain Australia's oldest human burials and the earliest evidence on Earth of cultural sophistication. 'At Lake Mungo, we have a cameo of people reacting to environmental change. It is one of the great stories of the people of the world.'

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Two rival groups of researchers have each attacked the techniques used by the other to ascertain the date of Mungo Man. In the 1999 study, Thorne's team used three techniques to date Mungo Man – bone, tooth enamel and sand. Bowler has strongly challenged the results ever since. Dating human bones is 'notoriously unreliable', he says. In addition, the sand sample used by Thorne's group was taken hundreds of metres from the burial site. Bowler has stated that it is not difficult 'to realise that the age of sand is not the same as the age of the grave'. He says his team's results are based on careful fieldwork, crosschecked between four laboratories, while Thorne's team misinterpreted the evidence, 'locked in a laboratory in Canberra'. Thorne counters that Bowler's team used one dating technique, while his used three. Best practice is to have at least two methods producing the same result. A Thorne team member, Professor Rainer Grün, says the fact that the latest results were consistent between laboratories doesn't mean they are correct. 'We now have two data sets that are contradictory. I do not have a plausible explanation.'

Thorne recently made headlines with a study of Mungo Man's DNA, which he claimed supported his idea that modern humans developed from archaic humans in several places around the world, rather than emerging from Africa a relatively short time ago. Now, however, Thorne says the age of Mungo Man is irrelevant. Recent fossil finds show that modern humans were in China 110,000 years ago. 'So he has a long time to arrive in Australia. It doesn't matter if he is 40,000 or 60,000 years old.'

In 2001, a member of Bowler's team, Dr Richard Roberts of Wollongong University, along with Flannery, Director of the South Australian Museum, published research on the extinction of the megafauna. They dated 28 sites across the continent, arguing that their analysis showed that the megafauna died out suddenly 46,600 years ago. This conclusion has been challenged by other scientists, including Dr Judith Field of the University of Sydney and Dr Richard Fullager of the Australian Museum, who point to the presence of megafauna fossils at the 36,000-year-old Cuddie Springs site in NSW.

Flannery praises the Bowler team's research as thorough and rigorous. He says the finding that humans arrived at Lake Mungo between 46,000 and 50,000 years ago supports the idea that that was a critical time in Australia's history. There is no evidence of a dramatic climate change at that time, he says. 'It's my view that humans arrived and megafauna extinction took place in almost the same geological instant.' Bowler, however, is sceptical of Flannery's theory about the disappearance of the giant animals. He argues that climate change 40,000 years ago was more intense than has been previously realised and could have played an important role in their extinction.

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Questions 1–8

Look at the following theories (Questions 1–8) and the list of researchers below. Match each theory with the correct researcher(s), **A–F**. *You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF RESEARCHERS

A Jim Bowler
B Alan Thorne
C Tim Flannery
D Rainer Grün
E Richard Roberts and Tim Flannery
F Judith Field and Richard Fullager

Q	Theory	Answer
1	Our human ancestors did not originate in only one area.	
2	The extinction of the megafauna happened within a brief period.	
3	The megafauna died out as a result of human activity.	
4	The similarity of results does not always guarantee their validity.	
5	How old Mungo Man is, is unimportant.	
6	There is evidence to disprove the theory of mass megafauna extinction.	
7	An extreme environmental change occurred at the time that humans first moved into the Lake Mungo area.	
8	The earliest evidence of advanced human culture is found in Australia.	

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Questions 9–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

9 Objects found in the Lake Mungo area were used to date the arrival of humans.

10 Ancient weapons were found in the Lake Mungo area.

11 Scientists agree about the age of Mungo Man.

12 Thorne's research involved analysing more than one material.

13 Bowler has criticised the research methods used by Thorne.

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Reading Passage 2

The Attraction of Video Games

The world's love of video games has much to do with people's desires and motives

A Video games, it is often claimed, are about wasting time. It is a misunderstanding that players and game makers have been trying to correct for many years. While movies and television are endlessly analysed in the media, games are often dismissed as irresponsible, unimportant by-products of the broader digital revolution.

But a growing number of experts disagree. This is, after all, an entertainment medium that worldwide makes $50b a year. Using ideas from psychology and sociology, theorists and designers suggest that our love of video games may actually have important things to tell us about our most basic desires and motivations.

Game design has become big business and has led to the creation of a multitude of companies. The industry attitude toward training has changed radically, says prominent game researcher Jesper Juul. "I recall hearing professionals claim that game design was a strange and unteachable art, but now this attitude has mostly faded. Designing video games is increasingly recognised as a valid field of university study throughout the world."

B Central to an understanding of games is the theory that games are fun because they teach us in a way that our brains prefer, that is, through systems and puzzles. Raph Koster, designer of multiplayer fantasy games, points out that an effective learning environment is one in which failure is acceptable, even welcomed. Accordingly, Koster says that in games, the player enters into a situation where the rules of the real world don't apply, and where being judged on success and failure isn't as significant a part of the experience.

When gaming, people feel free to try things and to learn, and not worry about what might happen.

Consistently, Koster says, the best games are the ones that provide us with interesting tools such as weapons or magic, and allow us to experiment with them. For example, in one early game, players are given the ability to jump, and can practise this for as long as they like, but to get to the next stage they need to master this ability so they can leap over an enemy and onto a platform. 'Games allow us to create these little systems where learning is controlled really brilliantly,' says Margaret Robertson, director at a London-based game design company. 'Something we don't talk about is that, actually, one of the strengths of games is the vague sense of disapproval that still surrounds them – they feel like something that's forbidden!' And that can, of course, be very exciting.

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C Another important element in the popularity of games is the player's ability to determine what happens. Games tap into our need to have direction; this is very obvious in games where we shape the lives of virtual humans, but it's becoming a vital element of action adventures too.

'Games are increasingly complex systems,' says Dan Pinchbeck, an experimental game designer. 'There's an emphasis on the pleasure of choosing and planning. We've moved quite dramatically away from the very first video games.' These games mostly involved the player merely reacting to events. But games then became more about approaching a situation and making a plan depending on your preferred play style.

D Many studios design their games around reward systems. 'A good game will have progression at the end of each level, but it will also provide surprise rewards halfway through,' says Ben Weedon, a games studio consultant. 'In a game, you're essentially pressing the same buttons and doing the same things over and over again, so you need those occasional surprises to stay motivated.'

E Games have constantly evolved over the years and continue to do so right up to the present. Now, incorporating a narrative structure into a game is becoming increasingly important. Many games have adopted Hollywood's three-act structure, which is designed to maintain our loyalty to a particular game. As in many films, a short final act is often used to give a sense of acceleration towards a preferably startling climax. Opening levels of games are also short, because this flatters us into thinking we're making good progress, whereas the middle levels are more extensive.

F Games even tap into our friendships. The rise of multiplayer gaming means that gaming increasingly involves social interaction. And other businesses are taking notice and using this as an element in advertising their brands. Then there's the new concept of 'gamification', in which websites and smartphone apps are being designed like games, with high scores and achievement points to keep customers entertained. Research estimates that businesses spent more than $100m worldwide on gamification projects last year, a figure predicted to rise to $1.6b in the next four years.

G So, in fact, games aren't just an insignificant fad, as some people might suggest. They fulfil intrinsic human needs, whether we are conscious of it or not. The loop of learning, control and rewards is at the heart of something very important, and very attractive.

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Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has six sections, **A–F**. *Choose the correct heading for each section from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Being able to experiment without consequences
ii Why stories are included in games
iii The key role of the unexpected for game players
iv Transferring features of games to other types of products
v The age group that games most appeal to
vi The development of the video game design industry
vii Players' ability to control what occurs in games

Q	Section	Answer
14	Section A	
15	Section B	
16	Section C	
17	Section D	
18	Section E	
19	Section F	

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Questions 20–23

Look at the following statements (Questions 20–23) and the list of experts below. Match each statement with the correct expert, **A–E**. *You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF EXPERTS

A Jesper Juul
B Raph Koster
C Margaret Robertson
D Dan Pinchbeck
E Ben Weedon

Q	Statement	Answer
20	Players' involvement in games often includes thinking ahead.	
21	The inclusion of unanticipated elements keeps players interested.	
22	It's now accepted that creating video games is a skill that can be learned.	
23	Early games were much simpler than more recent ones.	

Questions 24–26

Complete the sentences below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Koster believes that games remove people's fear of (24) ————————.

Robertson's view is that games feel exciting partly because of the (25) ———————— that is associated with them.

Narrative games are often structured so that the first and last part are (26) ————————.

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Reading Passage 3

Blind to Change

How much of the world around you do you really see?

Picture the following and prepare to be amazed. You're walking across a college campus when a stranger asks you for directions. While you're talking to him, two men pass between you carrying a wooden door. You feel a moment's irritation, but you carry on describing the route. When you've finished, you're told you've just taken part in a psychology experiment. "Did you notice anything after the two men passed with the door?" the stranger asks. "No," you reply uneasily. He explains that the man who initially approached you walked off behind the door leaving him in his place. The first man now rejoins you. Comparing them, you notice that they are of different height and build and are dressed very differently.

Daniel Simons of Harvard University found that 50% of participants missed the substitution because of what is called change blindness. When considered with a large number of recent experimental results, this phenomenon suggests we see far less than we think we do. Rather than logging every detail of the visual scene, says Simons, we are actually highly selective. Our impression of seeing everything is just that. In fact, we extract a few details and rely on memory, or even our imagination, for the rest.

Until recently, researchers thought that seeing involved making pictures in the brain. By building detailed internal representations of the world, and comparing them over time, we could spot any changes. Then in Consciousness Explained, the philosopher Daniel Dennett claimed that our brains hold only a few salient details about the world – and that is why we are able to operate successfully. In 1996, researcher John Grimes provided early experimental support for this view, showing that people often fail to notice significant changes made to a scene during a saccade, the rapid eye movement that occurs when the eyes jump from one fixation point to another. This phenomenon, known as change blindness, demonstrates that we don't actually see as much of the world as we believe. While it might seem that our eyes capture every detail of a scene, our brains often only register a fraction of it, relying heavily on memory and inference to fill in the gaps. This selective attention has broader implications than we might expect, extending into many aspects of our daily lives.

The simple act of driving. How many times have you missed a traffic signal change because your attention was momentarily diverted? This is not just a matter of distraction but a failure of our visual system to detect changes that do not seem immediately relevant. Researchers have even demonstrated that people can miss significant alterations in visual scenes, such as the appearance or disappearance of large objects, especially when their

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attention is focused elsewhere. One famous experiment involved showing participants a video of a basketball game. They were instructed to count the number of passes made by one team. In the middle of the game, a man in a gorilla suit walked through the scene, yet many participants failed to notice him.

This experiment highlights how attention can be so narrowly focused on a specific task that we become blind to other, seemingly obvious, changes around us.

Simons' work on change blindness reveals how our brain constructs a coherent reality out of fragments. The brain's ability to focus on what's deemed important at the time can lead to significant gaps in our perception. We may believe that we are aware of everything happening around us, but in reality, we only see what we need to see at that moment.

The implications of change blindness extend beyond simple experiments. In real-world situations, such as witnessing a crime or driving, our selective attention can have serious consequences. Eyewitness testimonies, for instance, may be unreliable because individuals often do not register all the details of an event, especially if their attention was focused elsewhere. This raises important questions about how much we can trust our perceptions and memories. Psychologist Christopher Chabris, who worked with Simons on the gorilla experiment, argues that understanding the limitations of our perception can help us better understand how the brain works. Rather than assuming that we see the world as it is, we must recognize that our experience of reality is shaped by our expectations, prior knowledge, and the limited capacity of our visual system.

The phenomenon of change blindness underscores the complexity of human perception. Our brains, while powerful, are not perfect recording devices. They prioritize information, often missing or altering details in the process. This selective attention allows us to function in a complex world but also leaves us vulnerable to mistakes and misinterpretations. As we continue to explore the intricacies of perception, it becomes increasingly clear that what we see is not always what is there.

Questions 27–33

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

27 What is the main topic of the passage?

A The impact of selective attention on driving
B The limitations of human perception and attention
C The history of psychological experiments
D The effectiveness of memory in recognising changes

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28 What does Daniel Simons' experiment demonstrate?

A That people notice changes if they are significant

B That people are always aware of their surroundings

C That change blindness is a common phenomenon

D That visual memory is accurate and reliable

29 What was the result of the basketball game experiment?

A Most participants noticed the man in the gorilla suit

B Only a few participants counted the passes correctly

C Many participants failed to notice the man in the gorilla suit

D Participants were distracted by the game and missed all changes

30 What did participants fail to notice in Simons' experiment?

A The change in the direction they were walking

B The substitution of the person asking for directions

C The presence of a wooden door between them

D The sudden disappearance of the stranger

31 What does the phenomenon of change blindness suggest?

A People can remember every detail they see

B People often miss significant changes in their environment

C Visual scenes are accurately captured by the brain

D Our brains create detailed images of the world

32 What did the basketball game experiment reveal about attention?

A Participants were more focused on the gorilla than the game

B People are always aware of their surroundings

C Attention to one task can lead to missing obvious changes

D Visual distractions do not affect attention

33 Why might eyewitness testimonies be unreliable, according to the passage?

A People tend to exaggerate what they see

B Visual memories are often incomplete and selective

C Witnesses are easily distracted during important events

D Everyone perceives reality in the same way

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Questions 34–36

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

34 Researchers have always believed that our brains capture every detail of a visual scene.

35 Daniel Dennett's theory suggested that our brains store detailed pictures of the world.

36 Eyewitness testimonies are completely reliable according to the passage.

Questions 37–40

Look at the following researchers (Questions 37–40) and the list of statements below. Match each researcher with the correct statement, **A–F**.

LIST OF STATEMENTS

A Suggested that the brain holds only a few details at a time
B Conducted the basketball game and gorilla suit experiment
C Demonstrated change blindness during eye movements
D Found that 50% of participants did not notice a change in a person
E Showed that people notice all changes if they are significant
F Studied the effects of long-term memory on perception

Q	Researcher	Answer
37	Daniel Simons	
38	Daniel Dennett	
39	Christopher Chabris	
40	John Grimes	

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 2

Volume 6 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The World's First Cities

The creation of Mesopotamian cities

The inhabitants of Mesopotamia – which now forms part of eastern Syria, southeastern Turkey and Iraq – lived for thousands of years on individual farms and in small, isolated communities, working relentlessly just to meet their basic needs. But then, about 6,000 years ago, something remarkable happened. The people left the security of their family homes and villages and came together with others to create something far more complex and difficult: the world's first city, called Uruk.

There is not much left now of Uruk, which is about 250 kilometres south of Iraq's capital Baghdad, but enough does remain to show that this initial experiment in urban living was extraordinarily successful. At its height, around 5,000 years ago, Uruk was home to more than 40,000 people. The outlines of the city walls indicate an enclosed area of about 600 hectares.

The archaeological record of Uruk reveals the intensive building and rebuilding which went on for four or five centuries after the city's initial establishment. In that period the people of Uruk built a dozen or so large public buildings. They would carefully level what had stood before, and then build another structure on top, often trying out a different building material or an innovative technique. They seemed to be searching for ways in which architecture could express the revolutionary new social structures that had come into being there.

Soon Uruk was not the only Mesopotamian city. People all across the flat plains of southern Mesopotamia were enjoying many of the benefits of city life. By about 4,500 years ago, 80 per cent of the Mesopotamian population lived in cities over 40 hectares in size, with populations of between 15,000 and 30,000 people. The emergence of these thriving communities, made up mostly of individuals and groups with no blood ties, was unprecedented in human history. Why did these extraordinary advances happen?

Reasons for the creation of cities in Mesopotamia

Smaller communities in Mesopotamia sometimes decided to come together to make it easier to defend themselves from their enemies. But the underlying reason for the creation of cities can be found in the harshness of this particular environment. The area was a place

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of extremes, where narrow strips of fertile river valleys were bounded by thousands of kilometres of desert and unproductive wetlands. As the small amount of rainfall in the region was incapable of sustaining anything but very limited agriculture, it was only through sophisticated irrigation that isolated pieces of land were kept fertile. The Tigris and the Euphrates rivers provided water for irrigation, and were also the basis of a communication system that led to the spread of the latest concepts in farming.

In such a region, the only way for humans to prosper was by forming groups that could work together. The threat of famine, which could be caused by a prolonged drought or the sudden change in the course of a river, forced people to look outside their families, and work with their neighbours to create an elaborate system of dams, channels and canals to manage water. These projects needed specific skills and labour from outside the farmer's family, and this established more firmly the patterns of dependence that are at the heart of civilisation.

Changes in the organisation of farming

The intensive farming that came about in Mesopotamia was more efficient and productive and therefore generated a surplus of food, allowing crops in years of good harvests to be stored as protection against future less successful years. It also allowed more land for the production of a wider range of crops. It created a world where there was a need for traders and for skilled craftsmen: in short, it was the beginning of industry and consumerism. The concept of specialisation emerged within the population with increasing numbers of soldiers, builders, musicians, doctors, fortune tellers all supported directly or indirectly by agriculture. At the same time, this increased the control that powerful institutions, gradually emerging in the early cities, had over the urban population. Although large numbers of people were freed from the struggle of subsistence farming, they were now totally dependent on the institutions that employed them for their daily sustenance.

The role of the temples

The earliest and most powerful of these institutions was centred on the religious temple. Ever more temple structures were erected in the form of massive pyramids which had enormous storerooms for the output from the farming estates. Over time, the temples acquired these farms for themselves, and appointed a large number of staff to administer them and to deal with the storage of produce. The temples' greatest advantage was that each citizen was expected to give up some time to work for the temples. This meant that temples could easily store huge amounts of agricultural produce which could be used to buy yet more land. In addition, the revenues generated allowed the temples to serve as primitive kinds of banks, making loans to people in difficult economic times.

The emergence of writing

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We know a surprising amount about these times thanks to the development of an important new technology: writing. In Mesopotamia basic records were inscribed in wet clay, unlike the fragile papyrus used in ancient Egypt and Greece. These first writings were largely lists of people and things, simple bookkeeping. But within several hundred years, writing systems had become more advanced, capable of recording concepts as well as lists. The clay tablets used for writing were tough, and the fires that often burnt down the archives where they were stored usually merely baked them for future generations.

Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1. Some physical evidence of Uruk still exists in Iraq.
2. The people of Uruk lived in large apartment buildings.
3. Builders in Uruk frequently experimented with new construction methods.
4. Urban settlements were unusual in Mesopotamia 4,500 years ago.
5. The Tigris and the Euphrates rivers were important for the interchange of ideas.
6. When there were food shortages, farmers relied mainly on the help of their relatives.

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Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Early changes in Mesopotamia

CHANGES IN ORGANISATION OF FARMING

Improved agricultural methods led to:

- a food (7) _____ being used as insurance
- a wider range of crops being grown
- the development of industry and consumerism
- increased specialisation amongst workers
- greater control by institutions

TEMPLES

- were built in the shape of large (8) _____
- had large (9) _____ where produce was kept
- many needed (10) _____ to manage the farms
- acted as (11) _____ in hard economic periods

THE DEVELOPMENT OF WRITING

- people wrote on surfaces made of (12) _____
- written records remained undamaged after (13) _____ in archives they were kept in

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Reading Passage 2

Australia's Camouflaged Creatures

Many species of animal in Australia protect themselves by using camouflage – a way of 'hiding' by blending into the surroundings

A Most species use camouflage to some extent. If they are convincing, they survive to pass their genes on to future generations. After generations of natural selection, animals can develop astonishingly complex camouflage techniques, manipulating shape, colour and movement. 'The principle of camouflage is to make it economically unviable for a predator to pursue a particular species of prey,' explains Professor Mark Elgar, of the University of Melbourne. 'Camouflage increases the search time and, as a consequence, the predator will simply target another species, either because it doesn't see the camouflaged individual or it just finds something more obvious to do.'

B The easiest way for an animal to disguise itself is to be invisible in its surroundings; to that end, stick and leaf insects have evolved complex camouflage to hide themselves from predators. Many have the texture of sticks or dry leaves, while others imitate living foliage, even the veins in a leaf. Some insects develop blemishes to match the spots caused by disease. A convincing appearance only works if its owner also acts the part, so during the day the creature using this type of camouflage keeps motionless, or sways like a dead leaf in the breeze. If disturbed, it falls to the ground and stays still. Entomologist Paul Zborowski, who has spent decades photographing inconspicuous creatures, rates the desert insects of Central Australia as the most convincingly disguised creatures he's seen. 'It's an incredibly old habitat so the creatures have had a long time to adapt,' Zborowski explains. Most of them behave like stones and don't move all day, feeding only at night.

C A tawny frogmouth sitting motionless on a stump also illustrates the importance of pairing a persuasive costume with behaviour. Professor Gisela Kaplan of the University of New England, in Australia, says the frogmouth's skill at camouflaging is learned behaviour. While adopting a pose may be a reflex of the bird, and can be observed in a hatchling's first week, the ability to choose a backdrop which matches its colouration does not develop for 4–6 months. When the chicks land they are usually highly conspicuous, and their parents try to signal to them to move to a safe location.

D Fixed camouflage is only good against a relatively unchanging environment, so some animals, such as the cuttlefish, have evolved an adaptable disguise. The cuttlefish can almost instantly change its colour, pattern and texture to match its surroundings, using specialised cells and muscles. On Queensland's reefs, scientists have been studying another ocean dweller that uses colour change, although not to blend into the surroundings. Dr

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Karen Cheney, from the University of Queensland, says the bluestriped fangblenny alters its colouration to mimic other species of fish, allowing it to travel with them and benefit from safety in numbers.

Its most impressive impersonation is of the black-with-neon-blue striped cleaner wrasse, which eats the parasites on larger fish. Not only does the fangblenny benefit from the reduced predation that comes with the wrasse's beneficial relationships with other fish, but the disguise also lets it get closer to prey. It darts out from the safety of the wrasse's cleaning station to nip at unsuspecting fish passing by, but doesn't attack those coming to be cleaned.

E The most famous form of mimicry, however, is for defence, not attack. Batesian mimicry refers to animals that gain protection from predators by imitating a dangerous organism, often using conspicuous colours. The nineteenth-century naturalist Henry Bates first suggested this camouflage technique after noticing that several Amazonian butterfly species looked the same. The technique was later named after him.

In Australian waters, the harmless harlequin snake eel sports the same black and white bandings as the highly toxic, yellow-lipped sea krait, ensuring no predator will attack. However, the success of Batesian mimicry depends on the ratio of mimics to originals. 'If a predator encounters too many that are edible, it will just assume none of the animals with those markings are dangerous,' explains Martyn Robinson, an educational naturalist with the Australian Museum.

F An imitation of a more dangerous creature needn't be exact, just enough to make potential predators hesitate. The hawk moth caterpillar has markings resembling a snake's eyes on its abdomen. When confronted, the caterpillar pulls its head in and the 'eyes' flash open. Whether the potential predator thinks it has seen a snake, or is simply startled is unclear, but the outcome is that the caterpillar lives to see another day.

G In Queensland's tablelands, the chameleon gecko has another way of making predators hesitate. Its body is brown, but its tail is banded in black and white. Robinson explains that if attacked, the chameleon gecko will drop off its tail, which will wriggle around on the ground. Many lizards do this, but in the case of the chameleon gecko the tail bones actually rub against one another, so it squeaks. 'The predator is, of course, thoroughly absorbed by this black-and-white-striped, wriggling, squeaking thing on the ground, and the gecko can sneak away,' Robinson says. 'It's a one-time-only trick: the regrown tail is brown, the same as the gecko's body.' Such precise disguise and elaborate trickery illustrate the limitless possibilities of nature. But, as Robinson points out, only the most successful illusionists are here to tell the tale.

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Questions 14–18

Reading Passage 2 has seven sections, **A–G**. *Which section contains the following information?*

Q	Information	Answer
14	a species that indicates to its young to move to a place where they are less visible	
15	an instance where sound is used to help an animal escape	
16	a creature that can use camouflage to match a range of different backgrounds	
17	a claim that the majority of animals disguise themselves in some way	
18	examples of animals that use camouflage to look like plants	

Questions 19–23

Look at the following statements (Questions 19–23) and the list of people below. Match each statement with the correct person, **A–F**.

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Professor Mark Elgar
B Paul Zborowski
C Professor Gisela Kaplan
D Dr Karen Cheney
E Henry Bates
F Martyn Robinson

Q	Statement	Answer
19	One species has a camouflage tactic that is not present from birth.	
20	Species that live in an ancient environment have become very effective at camouflaging themselves.	
21	Part of an animal is left behind to distract predators.	
22	If it takes too long to find one kind of prey, animals will look for an alternative source of food.	
23	Camouflage can involve copying a threatening type of animal.	

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Questions 24–26

Complete the summary below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The bluestriped fangblenny

Dr Karen Cheney studies the bluestriped fangblenny on (24) _____ off Queensland's coast. She found that the fangblenny was able to make itself resemble other fish by adjusting its colouration. The fangblenny impersonates the striped cleaner wrasse, a fish that is welcomed by other species as it gets rid of their (25) _____. The fangblenny can approach its (26) _____ without drawing the attention of predators or disturbing the work of the striped cleaner.

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Reading Passage 3

The Effectiveness of an Online Course

As access to the internet has continued to grow, web-based learning has continued to expand. With approximately half of the households in the United States (or 150 million people) connected to the Internet, an estimated 2 million students are taking post-secondary courses that are fully delivered online. Millions of other students at all educational levels (primary, secondary, post-secondary) participate in online courses. However, the effectiveness of online courses, particularly in relation to individual student needs, perceptions, and student outcomes, is sometimes questioned.

Common elements for learning in a typical classroom environment are the social and communicative interactions between student and teacher, and student and student. The ability to ask a question, to share an opinion with a fellow student, or to disagree with the point of view in a reading assignment are all fundamental learning activities. However, effective web-based learning requires adjustments on the part of students and teachers for successful interactions to occur. Many online courses provide students and faculty, and students and students, with the ability to interact with each other via an electronic bulletin or discussion board.

While most studies show a link between interaction and satisfaction in web-based courses, some observers have cautioned that this is not always the case. Ruberg, Taylor and Moore, for example, observe that in order to interact successfully, students must adjust to the nonlinear nature of web-based learning. Web-based learning sessions can have multiple threads with several discussions and interactions progressing simultaneously. Students respond to a teacher but also to other students, depending on the interest and points of view.

Sproull and Kiesler caution about discussions based on misinformation that continue because an instructor cannot necessarily immediately correct or clarify a comment. As a result, students need to have the experience and knowledge base to sift through the discussion for misinformation. In online learning, the amount of student interaction and the number of comments can easily lead to what is described as information overload. Furthermore, comments in online discussions tend to be lengthier than in face-to-face situations. With more information from many sources, students need to be more attentive to both the who and what of a discussion. Herbert Simon, an economist, cautions that 'a wealth of information creates a poverty of attention.'

In examinations of interaction, the concept of 'presence', or a sense of being in a place and belonging to a group, has received attention. It is generally assumed that when a student is physically present in a face-to-face course, he or she has a sense of belonging to the class or

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group enrolled in the course, and this sense of belonging is greater than that experienced in an online course. He or she listens to and may choose to raise a hand to comment, answer or ask a question. Furthermore, this same student may develop a relationship with other students in the class during a break. However, this is an assumption and not always true. For various reasons, some students can also feel alienated in a face-to-face class and not feel part of a group.

The idea of presence has been redefined in relation to an online course. The simplest definition of presence for an online course refers to a student's sense of being registered and belonging in a course, and the ability to interact with other students and an instructor even though physical contact is not available. However, as this concept is studied, the definition is expanding and being refined to include telepresence, cognitive presence, social presence, teaching presence, and other forms of presence. The term 'community' is related to presence, and refers to a group of individuals who belong to a social unit, such as students in a class. In an online course, however, terms such as communities of inquiry, communities of learners, and knowledge-building communities have evolved.

As the definition of presence has expanded and evolved, a distinction has been made between interaction and presence, emphasizing that they are not the same. Interaction may indicate presence, but it is also possible for a student to interact by posting a message on an electronic bulletin board, while not necessarily feeling that he or she is part of a group or a class.

A study conducted by Professor Anthony Picciano used questionnaires to determine students' attitudes in relation to their interactions and sense of purpose in online courses. An attempt was made to go beyond student perceptions to include performance and perceptions of social presence, as well as actual participation in class activities. In addition, data was collected on performance measures that related specifically to course objectives. While much of the research, including this study, supports the strong relationship between students' perception of interaction and perceived learning, the results of the study indicated that the relationship of actual measures of interaction and performance is mixed.

The success of many online courses is dependent upon the nature of student-to-student and student-to-faculty interaction. However, how interaction affects learning outcomes, and what the relationship between the two is, is in need of further study.

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Questions 27–31

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

27 Which of the following is mentioned in the article in relation to classroom-based learning?

A the development of academic skills
B the documenting of information
C the completion of assignments
D the exchange of ideas

28 Ruberg, Taylor and Moore point out that web-based learning requires learners to

A think sequentially
B research different points of view
C limit their responses to other students
D follow more than one discussion at a time

29 What problem did Sproull and Kiesler identify with online discussions?

A Online discussions demand less attention than face-to-face ones.
B Teachers have difficulty monitoring the length of comments.
C Face-to-face interactions between students are lost.
D There is a delay in giving feedback to students.

30 The writer refers to the concept of online presence as

A listening to a discussion
B a feeling of being part of a group
C posting ideas on an electronic bulletin board
D having a good relationship with other students

31 What was a focus of Anthony Picciano's study?

A to examine the relationship between presence and course outcomes
B to analyse the differences between online and class-based courses
C to examine the importance of being present in a classroom
D to demonstrate that online courses are not generally effective

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Questions 32–36

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

32 The ability of online courses to meet an individual participant's needs is unclear.

33 Researchers caution against building strong online relationships.

34 Common assumptions about the benefits of face-to-face courses have proved to be correct.

35 The meaning of presence is still being clarified.

36 Research on the impacts of interaction on learning outcomes has produced consistent results.

Questions 37–40

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–F***, below.*

SENTENCE ENDINGS

A is dependent on adapting to unfamiliar interaction formats.

B is key in determining whether a student has a sense of belonging in a course.

C is a subject that the writer believes will require more study.

D is essential to excel in study and scholarship.

E is key in determining whether a student feels they have learned something from a course.

F is important for determining their validity.

Q	Sentence start	Answer
37	The ability to succeed in an online course...	
38	The need to be mindful of the source of comments in an online discussion...	
39	In online courses, it is presence, rather than interaction, that...	
40	The relationship between interaction and learning achievement...	

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 3

Volume 6 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The Growth of Agriculture

Some developments in Western agriculture from prehistory to the nineteenth century

Agriculture is the art and science of cultivating the soil, growing crops and raising livestock. It includes the preparation of plant and animal products for people to use and their distribution to markets.

Before agriculture became widespread, prehistoric people spent most of their lives as nomadic people searching for food, following animal migrations and gathering wild plants. Then about 11,500 years ago, people gradually learned how to cultivate plants for food use and settled down to a life based on farming. Scholars are unsure why this shift to farming took place, but it may have occurred because of climate change. The earliest crop was most likely to have been rice, corn, or similar types of cereals. At around the same time, people also began herding and breeding animals. Sheep and goats were probably domesticated first, followed by cattle and pigs. Eventually, people started keeping animals such as oxen for ploughing and transportation.

Agriculture enabled people to produce a surplus of food which could be eaten when crops failed or swapped for other goods. This exchange of goods was how trade began, and this in turn allowed people to work at other tasks unrelated to farming. Agriculture also kept formerly nomadic people near their fields and led to the establishment of permanent villages which became linked through trade. This development was so successful in some areas that cities emerged, and eventually civilisations arose. The earliest of these developed near the Tigris and Euphrates rivers in Mesopotamia – now Iraq – and along the River Nile in Egypt, eventually spreading to Europe, Asia and beyond. For thousands of years, agricultural development was very slow. Farmers cultivated small plots of land by hand, using axes to clear away trees and sticks to break up and till the soil. However, over time, improved farming tools of bone, stone, bronze, and iron were developed. Around 7,500 years ago, farmers in Mesopotamia developed simple irrigation systems. By channelling water from streams onto their fields, farmers were able to settle in areas once thought to be unsuited to agriculture. In Mesopotamia and later in Egypt, people organised themselves and worked together to build these irrigation systems. Then, as the Roman empire expanded, the Romans adapted the best agricultural methods of the people they

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conquered. They even wrote manuals about the farming techniques they observed in Africa, Asia, and Europe. By 2,000 years ago, much of the Earth's population was reliant on agriculture.

In medieval times, European farmers adapted an open-field system of planting in which one field would be planted in spring, another in autumn, and one would be left unplanted, or fallow. This system preserved nutrients in the soil, increasing crop production. Later, in the 15th and 16th centuries, explorers travelling to Africa, Asia and the Americas began to introduce new varieties of plants into Europe. From the Americas, for example, they brought back agricultural products such as potatoes, tomatoes, maize and beans, which eventually became staple crops and an integral part of the European diet.

A period of major agricultural development began in the early 1700s for Great Britain and northern Europe. One of the most important of these developments was the horse-drawn seed drill, invented in England by Jethro Tull. Until that time, farmers sowed seeds by hand. Tull's invention made rows of holes for the seeds and dropped them into the holes, thus greatly improving the speed and efficiency of the process. By the end of the 18th century, seed drilling was widely practiced in many countries across Europe.

Although new machines were being introduced, there were also several other important advances in farming methods. By selectively breeding their livestock – deliberately breeding animals with a certain combination of desirable qualities from chosen parent animals – farmers increased both the size of their herds and the productivity of their livestock. An early example of this is the Leicester sheep, an animal selectively bred in England for its quality meat and long, coarse wool. Then, in Austria in 1866, a monk and science teacher by the name of Gregor Mendel published his studies of heredity, which were the first to show how traits are passed from one generation of plants to the next. Mendel is widely recognised as the founder of the science of genetics, and his experiments paved the way for the selective breeding of plants and the improvement of crops through genetics.

Another major agricultural breakthrough came from the field of chemistry. For thousands of years, farmers had relied on natural fertiliser – materials such as animal or bird waste, wood ash, or ground bones – to replenish or increase nutrients in the soil. Then, in the early 1800s, scientists discovered which elements were most essential to plant growth: nitrogen, phosphorus, and potassium. This led to the manufacture of chemical fertilisers based on nitrates and phosphates, which greatly increased crop yields. With the population of Europe doubling during the 1800s – from around 200 million at the beginning of the century to around 400 million mouths to feed at its end – farming had finally become big business.

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Questions 1–7

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

Farming in the ancient world

Prehistoric times – people collected wild plants, and (1) _____ to get meat

- 11,500 years ago – people began growing crops, probably (2) _____, e.g. rice or corn
  – people started to domesticate various types of animals
- Creation of a (3) _____ led to the exchange of goods and the beginnings of trade, which resulted in the emergence of cities and the growth of (4) _____
- Farmers gradually began using better (5) _____ made from different materials
- Systems of providing a supply of (6) _____ were invented in Mesopotamia
- (7) _____ years ago, a large proportion of people worldwide had become dependent on farming

Questions 8–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

(8) The Romans adapted their own farming methods for use in Africa and Asia.

(9) The medieval open-field system increased food production by allowing European farmers to have crops growing continually in all their fields.

(10) European eating habits changed as a result of international exploration in the 15th and 16th centuries.

(11) During the 18th century many European countries created their own versions of the seed drill.

(12) Selective breeding methods helped European farmers to produce more animals.

(13) Many farmers continued to use natural methods of fertilising their land, even after the development of chemical fertilisers.

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Reading Passage 2

The Aerofoil

The shape of an aeroplane's wing plays a key role in the achievement of flight

A The magic of flight lies in the interaction between the wings of a plane and the air. If the shape of the wing – the aerofoil – is right and the plane is moving fast enough, the wing is pushed into the air as it slices through it. It seems like magic because our all-too-literal brains tell us that because air is invisible it must be insubstantial too. But air is not nothing; air is a substance completely comprised of gases. If you think of a wing slicing through water rather than air, you can begin to imagine how air might provide the upward push that aeronautical scientists call lift. The key to the aerofoil is the flow of air around it. Air flows around an aerofoil because the aerofoil is moving. Just as the bow of a boat creates a flow in still water, what matters is the way the curved shape of the aerofoil diverts the flow around it.

B To really see why, it is worth carrying out an experiment with knives and spoons under a running tap. Hold the blade of a knife vertically in a stream of water and the water flows straight and undisturbed past the blade. Twist the blade slightly at an angle to the stream and you can see how it begins to block and split the flow, breaking it into turbulent eddies – and you may see the turbulence increase as you increase the angle of the knife. Hold the convex side of a spoon under the stream instead, however, and something different happens. The spoon diverts the water but does not disrupt it. You have to twist the spoon at a much steeper angle before it disrupts the flow. Like the curvature of the spoon, the curvature of the aerofoil ensures the flow of the air around it is diverted but not broken up.

C The curvature of the spoon, like that of the aerofoil, is crucial. Far above or below the aerofoil the airflow is undisturbed, but the closer the air is to the aerofoil the more the flow is bent to follow the aerofoil's shape. As the air changes direction, it begins to push in a different direction too, and the more it bends, the greater the change. Right on top and underneath the aerofoil, the airflow is turned effectively at right angles, pushing the aerofoil upwards and creating lift. Since it is the way that the airflow is distorted that creates lift, it is evident that the pattern of the airflow distortion is critical. This depends on the angle that the aerofoil moves through the air – its angle of attack. The steeper the angle, the greater the lift.

D The overall shape of the aerofoil is also crucial. Hang-gliders and microlights have a gentle, thin curve to their wings, and birds' wings bend into a similar shape, which gives excellent lift for a light aircraft or a bird. But it is hard to make a wing of this shape strong enough for a large aircraft. So, to support their far greater weight, the wings of most large planes are, in profile, the shape of a narrow teardrop, which is why the wings have to be so

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huge to still generate enough lift. This shape does not waste the extra room, however: the fuel needed to power a flight is stored inside each wing. At the ends of the wings are flaps, which can be swung up or down to alter the aerofoil's curvature and its effective angle of attack, and so allow the aircraft to climb or descend.

E Of course the wings of birds were the original inspiration for the aerofoil. Countless thinkers in the distant past must have marvelled at birds gliding through the sky and guessed that they were held aloft by their outstretched wings. And perhaps it was the early Greek philosophers who were said to have built a mechanical bird that flew. Brave pioneers like the 9th-century Cordoban inventor, Abbas Ibn-Firnas, were even bold enough to strap artificial wings to their arms and leap from high places. Ibn-Firnas was lucky enough to glide through the air for ten minutes before crash-landing and almost breaking his neck.

F Yet the first person who really began to explore the shape of wings methodically was the British engineer Sir George Cayley (1773–1857), and it is to Cayley that we owe the idea of the curved aerofoil. Cayley was an extraordinary and inventive man, and he is credited with developing self-righting lifeboats, wire-spoked wheels, seatbelts and even an internal combustion engine. But it is mostly as the father of aviation that he is remembered, and it is he who pioneered much of the theory of flight. He carried out numerous experiments to establish what shapes and angles produced the greatest lift. In his analyses, he developed the names of the key forces involved in flight – lift, drag and thrust – which still play an important role today. Flight involves a balance between these four forces, but for a successful aeroplane you need both power and control, which is why it took another half-century before Orville and Wilbur Wright made their historic flight at Kittyhawk in the USA on 17th December 1903.

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Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, **A–F**. *Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i The earliest attempts to achieve human flight

ii Public reaction to the pioneers of flight

iii A practical demonstration of an aeronautical principle

iv The importance of angles in achieving lift

v A misunderstanding about the nature of air

vi The discovery of several key factors affecting wing design

vii Additional wing features that help control flight

Q	Paragraph	Answer
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph B	
16	Paragraph C	
17	Paragraph D	
18	Paragraph E	
19	Paragraph F	

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Questions 20–24

Complete the summary below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Designing aeroplane wings

Hang-gliders, microlights, small planes and birds share the same wing shape – a curve which provides the maximum amount of (20) _____. But while these wings can support an individual person, they cannot support the weight of a huge aircraft. In fact, the enormous wings of a modern plane look like a thin (21) _____ when viewed from the side. Space is not wasted because the (22) _____ needed to power a flight is kept inside each wing. The pilot can adjust the (23) _____ which are located at the (24) _____ of the wings. This changes the aerofoil's curvature as well as the angle of attack and causes the plane to rise or descend.

Questions 25 and 26

Choose **TWO** *letters,* **A–E**. *Which TWO things does the writer state about George Cayley?*

A He made a lot of money from his inventions

B He understood how to design aeroplane engines 50 years before Orville and Wilbur Wright

C His studies included how to achieve the maximum lift

D He worked closely with other scientists

E He reached his conclusions by conducting a series of tests

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Reading Passage 3

Looking for Inspiration

Helen Phillips asks what makes one person more creative than another

People have speculated about their own creativity for centuries – perhaps ever since we became able to think about thinking. Whatever creativity is, it is thinking at its highest level; creativity is a way of coming up with new ideas and new ways of doing things. The only bit of the creative process we actually know about is the moment of insight, yet creative ideas and projects may incubate beyond our awareness for months. Not surprising, then, that creativity has long eluded scientific study.

In the early 1900s, it was still seen as a type of intelligence. But when more subtle tests of IQ and creative skills were developed in the 1970s, particularly by the father of creative testing, Paul Torrance, it became clear that the link was not so simple. Creative people are intelligent, in terms of IQ tests at least, but only averagely or just above. While it depends on the discipline, in general, having beyond a certain level of IQ does not help boost creativity.

Because of the difficulty of studying the actual process, most early attempts to study creativity concentrated on personality. According to creativity specialist Mark Runco at California State University, the creative personality tends to place a high value on aesthetic qualities and have broad interests, providing lots of resources to draw on and knowledge to recombine into novel solutions. 'Creatives have an attraction to complexity and an ability to handle conflict. They are also highly self-motivated, perhaps even a little obsessive, when it comes to realising their ambitions.'

But there may be a price to pay for having a creative personality. For centuries, a link has been made between creativity and mental illness. Psychiatrist and author Kay Redfield Jamison of Johns Hopkins University, who herself has bipolar disorder, found that established artists are significantly more likely to have mood disorders. But she also suggests that a switch of mood state might be the key to triggering a creative event, rather than the negative mood itself.

Jordan Peterson, a psychologist at the University of Toronto, has carried out work that suggests that the brains of creative people are more open to incoming stimuli than less creative types. Our senses are continually feeding a mass of data into our brains, which have to block most of it to save us from being snowed under. Peterson calls this process latent inhibition and argues that people who have less of it, and who have a reasonably high IQ, can juggle more of the data, and so may be open to more ideas.

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But what of the creative act itself? One of the first studies of the creative brain at work was by Colin Martindale, a psychologist from the University of Maine. Back in 1978, he used a network of scalp electrodes to record the pattern of brain waves as people made up stories. Creativity, he showed, has two stages: inspiration and elaboration, each characterized by very different states of mind. While people were dreaming up their stories, he found their brains were surprisingly quiet. The dominant activity was alpha waves, which is the same sort of brain activity as in some stages of dreaming or rest. This could explain why sleep and relaxation can help people be creative.

However, when these quiet-minded people were asked to work on their stories, the alpha wave activity dropped off and the brain became busier, revealing increased cortical arousal, and more organised thinking. Strikingly, it was the people who showed the biggest difference in brain activity between the two stages who produced the most creative storylines. Nothing in their background brain activity marked them as creative or uncreative. 'It's as if the less creative person can't move up a gear,' says Guy Claxton, a psychologist at the University of Bristol. 'Creativity requires different kinds of thinking. Very creative people move between these states intuitively.'

Researchers are now trying to identify some of the specific anatomy of creativity. Brain studies of people with particular types of creative skill show, perhaps not surprisingly, that active areas are determined by the specialist knowledge being used. Imagery, spatial awareness, language and so on – whatever the skill, it is limited to some extent to a particular brain part or parts. But it's not just these specialist areas that are active. Using information creatively needs coordination. 'Creative synthesis requires a new pattern, to put the brain in a state where many areas are simultaneously active,' says Claxton. When we concentrate in a less creative way, such as when reading the gas bill, there are fewer active centres and less synthesis.

But to be truly creative needs more than just the right personality and the right brain areas and networks. It's about using them efficiently. Skills, situations and resources we are born with shape our creativity just as dramatically as the way we manage our own daily rhythms. Creative people often organise their time carefully, using the mornings, the evenings, the weekends and the holidays to help alter focus and brain state. They may spend two hours at their desk, then go for a walk, because they know that pattern works for them.

Another often forgotten aspect of creativity is social. Vera John-Steiner of the University of New Mexico says that to be really creative you need strong social networks and trusting relationships, not just active neural networks. One vital characteristic of a 'creative', she says, is that they have at least one other person in their life who doesn't think they are completely mad!

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Questions 27–32

Look at the following statements (Questions 27–32) and the list of people below. Match each statement with the correct person, **A–G**. *You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Paul Torrance
B Mark Runco
C Kay Redfield Jamison
D Jordan Peterson
E Colin Martindale
F Guy Claxton
G Vera John-Steiner

Q	Statement	Answer
27	Creative people are receptive to the immense amounts of information that the brain has to deal with.	
28	Creativity requires numerous parts of the brain to be active at the same time.	
29	Creative people engage in, and are well informed about, a wide range of subjects.	
30	Creative people may have unstable personalities.	
31	Creative people are driven to achieve the goals they set themselves.	
32	Creative people need support from others.	

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Questions 33–36

Complete the summary below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

Colin Martindale carried out research into the creative brain at work. For his study, volunteers had a series of (33) _____ placed on their heads which were used to monitor brain activity while they made up stories. Martindale demonstrated that creativity consisted of (34) _____ and elaboration phases. In the first of these, the brain was mostly inactive except for (35) _____, and this corresponds to what takes place during dreaming or relaxation. In the second phase, when the volunteers worked on their stories, however, their brains became a lot busier. Interestingly, the most creative stories were produced by those volunteers with the greatest (36) _____ in brain activity between the two phases.

Questions 37–40

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

(37) People with very high IQs are more likely to be creative than those with average IQs.

(38) Society tends to value aesthetic skills highly.

(39) There can be disadvantages to having a creative personality.

(40) Language skills are more important than spatial awareness in any form of creativity.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 4

Volume 6 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Radiocarbon Dating – The Profile of Nancy Athfield

Have you ever picked up a small stone off the ground and wondered how old it was? Chances are, that stone has been around many more years than your own lifetime. Many scientists share this curiosity about the age of inanimate objects like rocks, fossils and precious stones. Knowing how old an object is can provide valuable information about our prehistoric past.

In most societies, human beings have kept track of history through writing. However, scientists are still curious about the world before writing, or even the world before humans. Studying the age of objects is our best way to piece together histories of our pre-historic past. One such method of finding the age of an object is called radiocarbon dating. This method can find the age of any object based on the kind of particles and atoms that are found inside of the object. Depending on what elements the object is composed of, radiocarbon can be a reliable way to find an object's age. One famous specialist in this method is the researcher Nancy Athfield. Athfield studied the ancient remains found in the country of Cambodia. Many prehistoric remains were discovered by the local people of Cambodia. These objects were thought to belong to some of the original groups of humans that first came to the country of Cambodia. The remains had never been scientifically studied, so Nancy was greatly intrigued by the opportunity to use modern methods to discover the true age of these ancient objects.

Athfield had this unique opportunity because her team, comprised of scientists and filmmakers, were in Cambodia working on a documentary. The team was trying to discover evidence to prove a controversial claim in history: that Cambodia was the resting place for the famous royal family of Angkor. At that time, written records and historic accounts conflicted on the true resting place. Many people across the world disagreed over where the final resting place was. For the first time, Athfield and her team had a chance to use radiocarbon dating to find new evidence. They had a chance to solve the historic mystery that many had been arguing over for years.

Athfield and her team conducted radiocarbon dating of many of the ancient objects found in the historic site of Angkor Wat. Nancy found the history of Angkor went back to as early as 1620. According to historic records, the remains of the Angkor royal family were much younger than that, so this evidence cast a lot of doubt as to the status of the ancient

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remains. The research ultimately raised more questions. If the remains were not of the royal family, then whose remains were being kept in the ancient site? Athfield's team left Cambodia with more questions unanswered. Since Athfield's team studied the remains, new remains have been unearthed at the ancient site of Angkor Wat, so it is possible that these new remains could be the true remains of the royal family. Nancy wished to come back to continue her research one day.

In her early years, the career of Athfield was very unconventional. She didn't start her career as a scientist. At the beginning, she would take any kind of job to pay her bills. Most of them were low-paying jobs or brief community service opportunities. She worked often but didn't know what path she would ultimately take. But eventually, her friend suggested that Athfield invest in getting a degree. The friend recommended that Athfield attend a nearby university. Though doubtful of her own qualifications, she applied and was eventually accepted by the school. It was there that she met Willard Libby, the inventor of radiocarbon dating. She took his class and soon had the opportunity to complete hands-on research. She soon realised that science was her passion. After graduation, she quickly found a job in a research institution.

After college, Athfield's career in science blossomed. She eventually married, and her husband landed a job at the prestigious organisation GNS. Athfield joined her husband in the same organisation, and she became a lab manager in the institution. She earned her PhD in scientific research, and completed her studies on a kind of rat when it first appeared in New Zealand. There, she created original research and found many flaws in the methods being used in New Zealand laboratories. Her research showed that the subject's diet led to the fault in the earlier research. She was seen as an expert by her peers in New Zealand, and her opinion and expertise were widely respected. She had come a long way from her old days of working odd jobs. It seemed that Athfield's career was finally taking off.

But Athfield's interest in scientific laboratories wasn't her only interest. She didn't settle down in New Zealand. Instead, she expanded her areas of expertise. Athfield eventually joined the field of anthropology, the study of human societies, and became a well-qualified archaeologist. It was during her blossoming career as an archaeologist that Athfield became involved with the famous Cambodia project. Even as the filmmakers ran out of funding and left Cambodia, Athfield continued to stay and continue her research.

In 2003, the film was finished with uncertain conclusions, but Nancy continued her research on the ancient ruins of Angkor Wat. This research was not always easy. Her research was often delayed by lack of funding, and government paperwork. Despite her struggles, she committed to finishing her research. Finally, she made a breakthrough. Using radiocarbon dating, Athfield completed a database for the materials found in

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Cambodia. As a newcomer to Cambodia, she lacked a complete knowledge of Cambodian geology, which made this feat even more difficult. Through steady determination and ingenuity, Athfield finally completed the database. Though many did not believe she could finish, her research now remains an influential and tremendous contribution to geological sciences in Cambodia. In the future, radiocarbon dating continues to be a valuable research skill. Athfield will be remembered as one of the first to bring this scientific method to the study of the ancient ruins of Angkor Wat.

Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement is true* • **FALSE** *if the statement is false* • **NOT GIVEN** *if the information is not given in the passage*

1. Nancy Athfield first discovered the ancient remains in Cambodia.
2. The remains found in Cambodia was in good condition.
3. Nancy took some time off from her regular work to do research in Cambodia.
4. The Cambodia government asked Nancy to radiocarbon date the remains.
5. The filmmakers aimed to find out how Angkor was rebuilt.
6. Nancy initially doubted whether the royal family was hidden in Cambodia.
7. Nancy disproved the possibility that the remains belonged to the Angkor royal family.

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Questions 8–13

Complete the flow-chart below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The Career of Nancy Athfield

In her mid-teens, Nancy wasn't expected to attend (8) ———

↓

Willard Libby later helped Nancy find that she was interested in science.

↓

Her PhD research examined a kind of (9) ——— when it first appeared in New Zealand.

↓

Her research showed that the subject's (10) ——— accounted for the fault in the earlier research.

↓

She was a professional (11) ——— before she went back to Cambodia in 2003.

↓

When she returned to Cambodia, the lack of (12) ——— was a barrier for her research.

↓

Then she compiled the (13) ——— of the Cambodia radiocarbon dating of the ancients.

↓

After that, the lack of a detailed map of the geology of Cambodia became a hindrance of her research.

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Reading Passage 2

How Sleep Helps Us Learn

Researchers are uncovering the link between sleep and learning and how it changes throughout our lives

A Most research into the relationship between memory and sleep has traditionally been conducted using young adults or animals. By the early 2000s, scientists had found that sleep helps young adults consolidate memory by reinforcing and filing away daytime experiences. But the older adults that Rebecca Spencer was studying at the U.S. University of Massachusetts Amherst didn't seem to experience the same benefit. Spencer wondered if age altered the relationship between sleep and memory, and chose nearby preschool children as subjects. She found that the children who regularly had short sleeps during the day benefited the most from daytime rest, largely because their memories decayed the most without these naps. "By staying awake, they have more interference from daytime experiences," Spencer explains.

B The studies on young adults carried out in the early 2000s suggested that the reduced sensory inputs during sleep allow the brain to replay daytime experiences during a period relatively free of distracting information. This may help to solidify connections and transfer daytime memories from one part of the brain known as the hippocampus into long-term storage in the brain region called the cortex. But how sleep and memory interact at different periods of our lives remained an open question.

C In children younger than 18 months, learning is thought to occur in the cortex because the hippocampus isn't yet fully developed. As a result, researchers hypothesize that infants don't replay memories during sleep, the way adults do. Instead, sleep merely seems to prevent infants from forgetting as much as they would if they were awake. "The net effect is that sleep permits infants to retain more of the redundant details of a learning experience," says experimental psychologist Rebecca Gómez of the University of Arizona. "By the time they are two years old, we think that children have the brain development that supports an active process of consolidation," she adds.

D From the age of two, adequate sleep during the hours of darkness becomes critical for learning. Toddlers who sleep less than 10 hours display lasting cognitive deficits, even if they catch up on sleep later in their development. The effects are particularly strong in children with developmental disorders, who often suffer from disturbed sleep. Jamie Edgin of the University of Arizona studied children with the genetic disorder Down's syndrome, comparing those who were sleep-impaired with those who slept normally. She

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found that there were large differences in language knowledge and observed that the non-sleep-impaired children knew up to 190 more words, even after controlling for behavioural differences.

E Understanding the impact of sleep on memory could also help another at-risk group of learners at the other end of the age spectrum. Previous research has suggested that older adults don't remember recently acquired motor skills as well as young adults do. But neuroscientist Maria Korman and her colleagues at the University of Haifa in Israel recently demonstrated that taking a nap soon after learning can allow the elderly to retain procedural memories just as well as younger people. Korman hypothesizes that by shortening the interval between learning and consolidation, the nap prevents intervening experiences from weakening the memory before it solidifies. Overnight sleep might be even better, if the motor skills – in this case, a complex sequence of finger and thumb movements on the non-dominant hand – are taught late enough in the day.

F Optimizing the timing of sleep and training in the elderly exploits something Korman sees as a positive side of growing old. "As we age, our neural system becomes more aware of the relevance of the task," Korman says. Unlike young adults, who solidify all the information they acquire throughout the day, older people consolidate those experiences that were tagged by the brain as very important.

G Tests on older adults' memories are generating new findings about the relationship between sleep and memory at other ages as well. After learning at a conference about a memory test for cognitive impairment and dementia in older adults, neuroscientist Jeanne Duffy of Brigham and Women's Hospital in Boston wondered if sleep could help strengthen the connection between names and faces. She and her colleagues found that young adults who slept overnight after learning a list of 20 names and faces showed a 12 percent increase in retention when tested 12 hours later, compared with subjects who didn't sleep between training and testing. The findings have "an immediate real-world application," Duffy says, as they address a common memory concern among people of all ages.

H Developing a fuller picture of what happens to memories during sleep – and how best to modify sleep habits to aid the recall process – could benefit some of society's most sleep-deprived members of every age. "We need to understand this role of sleep in memory because there is such potential for intervention," Spencer says. "Now that we have a well-founded concept of what sleep can do for memory, it's time to put it to the test."

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Questions 14–19

The reading passage has eight paragraphs, **A–H**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?*

Q	Information	Answer
14	A description of how sleep helps infants retain details of their experiences	
15	A comparison between the memory consolidation processes of young and older adults	
16	A study showing how sleep deprivation affects language development in children with a genetic disorder	
17	A reference to the role of the hippocampus in memory storage	
18	A suggestion that overnight sleep may be more effective for learning certain skills	
19	An example of a real-world application of sleep research	

Questions 20–23

Complete the summary below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Sleep and memory

In the past, most studies looking into how sleep helps us consolidate memories have used either animals or young adults as their subjects. But Rebecca Spencer noticed that her own research subjects did not appear to get as much (20) _____ benefit from sleep as the subjects in other studies did. She wanted to know if a person's (21) _____ made any difference to the process of memory consolidation, so she conducted an experiment on children at the (22) _____ stage. She found that children who did not have a daytime sleep suffered a higher level of (23) _____ from the day's events, and were less able to remember things later.

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Questions 24–26

Look at the following research areas (Questions 24–26) and the list of researchers below. Match each statement with the correct researcher, **A–E**.

LIST OF RESEARCHERS

A Rebecca Spencer

B Rebecca Gómez

C Jamie Edgin

D Maria Korman

E Jeanne Duffy

Q	Research area	Answer
24	The connection between lack of sleep and vocabulary acquisition	
25	The impact of sleep on how well people learn to perform physical actions	
26	How the structure of very young brains may influence memory processes	

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Reading Passage 3

Petrol Power: An Eco-Revolution?

Laura Ingalls Wilder's semi-autobiographical novel The Long Winter describes how the inhabitants of a small town called De Smet in the American Mid-West narrowly avoided starvation during the severe winter of 1880–1881. Over three metres of snow fell on the northern plains, immobilising the railways and cutting off the settlers from the rest of the world. Laura and her neighbours were only saved when her fiancé and his friend trudged 30 kilometres through the snow to fetch food, risking their lives in the process. The story is a reminder of how lethal geographical isolation and crop failures could be before the advent of modern farming and transportation technologies. Not long ago, subsistence farmers in many countries had to cope with the 'lean season' – the period of greatest scarcity before the new crops became available. In England, late spring was once referred to as the 'hungry gap.' The situation was made worse by the cost of moving heavy things over muddy dirt roads. Three centuries ago, moving goods 50 kilometres on land between, say, Liverpool and Manchester was as expensive as shipping them across the North Atlantic.

The development of coal-powered railways and steamships in the 19th century revolutionised the lives of farmers. Instead of having to grow everything they needed, they could now specialise in what they did best and rely on other producers for their remaining needs. The result was not only ever-cheaper prices, but the end of widespread famine, as food from regions with good harvests could now be transported to those that had experienced mediocre ones. Since then, petroleum-derived fuels have largely displaced coal because of their higher energy density, cleaner combustion and greater ease of extraction, further improving road and rail transportation systems.

While the convenience of modern methods of transportation is obvious, few people grasp their historical significance. In 1898, delegates gathered in New York City for the world's first international urban-planning conference. The topic that dominated discussions was not infrastructure or housing, but horse manure. The problem was that as the populations of cities like New York and London grew, the number of horses there also grew, and in New York these produced nearly two million kilograms of manure each day. If this problem continued it was estimated that by 1950 every street in London would be buried three metres deep in horse manure. Unable to think of any solution, the delegates concluded that urban living was inherently unsustainable.

Paradoxically, the shift to deliver perishable goods, such as meat and dairy products, from locations that benefited from better soil and climate put many farms located near cities out of business. As demand for oats and hay to feed urban workhorses grew, the pressure this

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placed on land and resources was felt both in the cities and in the countryside. In the cities, manure heaps created unpleasant smells and became breeding grounds for house flies; perhaps three billion flies were hatched each day in US cities in the early 20th century, contributing to the spread of diseases such as cholera and dysentery. Horses could also be dangerous: a startled or bolting horse, or a heavy wagon that lost control, could easily injure pedestrians in the crowded streets. The clatter of wagon wheels on cobbled pavement could be deafening, and since a horse and wagon occupied more street space than a modern truck, they also created significant traffic congestion, while a horse that collapsed on the road became an obstruction that was difficult to remove. The countryside also suffered. To supply the workhorses with oats and hay, additional land had to be cleared of its natural vegetation, and sometimes water had to be diverted to irrigate it, with considerable negative effects on the wider environment.

So, while the trains, cars and trucks of the early 20th century were noisy and polluting by today's standards, they nonetheless represented real progress. Previously, poor soils had often meant that a large amount of land was required to sustain a household, and much environmental damage, primarily in the form of soil erosion, was caused by farmers trying to work these poor soils. It could be argued that modern transportation allowed the development of remote regions like the Canadian prairies, and allowed more suitable crops to be grown in the poorer soils of Europe, before being sold elsewhere.

Over time, the concentration of food production in the world's best locations allowed some agricultural land to revert to a wild state. For instance, France benefited from an expansion of its forest area by one third between 1830 and 1960. This so-called 'forest transition' occurred in the context of a doubling of the French population and a dramatic increase in standards of living. Improvements in logistics also allowed the production and export of food from locations where water was abundant to regions where it was scarce, thus preventing the depletion of water resources there. It also made possible a drastic increase in the size of our cities. Contrary to what most people believe, the growth in cities is a positive development. In the words of economist Ed Glaeser: "Residing in a forest might seem to be a good way of showing one's love of nature, but living in a concrete jungle is actually far more ecologically friendly." If you love nature, stay away from it. It could be argued that modern transportation technologies have been a major contributor to a wealthier, cleaner and more sustainable world.

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Questions 27–30

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

27 Why were the inhabitants of De Smet in danger of starvation?

A The trains were unable to operate normally.
B The harvest had been completely destroyed.
C Their access to food was limited for certain times.
D The roads to the town had not yet been built.

28 What problem did subsistence farmers have in the past?

A They had no effective means of storing food.
B Food was expensive because of high shipping costs.
C Their access to food was limited for certain times.
D Food could not be transported for long distances by road.

29 The writer says that the use of coal to power railways and steamships

A led to a greater range of fresh vegetables being available in urban areas.
B was less efficient than the use of petroleum-derived products.
C allowed farmers to be more self-sufficient than they were previously.
D was better for the environment than using petroleum-derived products.

30 The writer refers to an urban planning conference held in 1898 in order to

A illustrate a problem that was later solved by modern technology.
B give an example of poor decisions made about urban planning.
C show that urban issues were misunderstood in the past.
D indicate the disregard at the time for public health concerns.

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Questions 31–35

Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–J**, *below.*

Problems caused by urban workhorses

WORD LIST

A rich landowners
B injuries
C food
D accidental falls
E environment
F dangerous area
G use of irrigation
H unpleasant smells
I treatment
J diseases

In cities, the large amounts of horse manure led to certain (31) _____ in the streets and was also linked to the spread of (32) _____. In certain situations, the horses might even cause (33) _____ to passers-by. There were also the problems of noise and congestion caused by horse-drawn vehicles. In the countryside, there were problems too. The (34) _____ was damaged because of the need to provide (35) _____ for urban workhorses.

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Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

36 Farmers whose land was poor failed to benefit from modern forms of transport.

37 Between 1830 and 1960 there were positive effects associated with changing patterns of agriculture in France.

38 A fairer distribution of the world's water resources is needed.

39 Living in the countryside does less harm to the environment than living in a city.

40 It is possible that modern developments in transportation have had an effect which is largely positive.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 5

Volume 6 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Studies in the History of Art and Visual Culture

General Information

The Department of the History of Art, which operates within the Faculty of History, offers a one-year postgraduate course in the History of Art and Visual Culture. We welcome applicants from a broad range of backgrounds and do not require students to have a first degree in art history. In addition to a compulsory course on Theory and Methods, students take two one-term optional courses, and write a 15,000-word dissertation on a topic of their choice. The course aims to redefine art history and includes a broader range of objects and visual media than other art history courses. Images and objects produced in many contexts – ranging from the scientific to the popular – have been brought together to show how visual styles at different periods and in different places can be understood in relation to the aesthetic, intellectual and social facets of various cultures.

Theory and Methods

This core course provides an advanced introduction to the major methodological issues and traditions of art history. The course is organised around a series of issues that relate to the production of art and people's responses to it. Students will discuss these issues and assigned readings in small weekly classes. In lectures, the tutors will consider works of art from a variety of cultures in order to demonstrate that context and artistic method are important aspects of art history.

Choosing Courses

The optional courses listed below are not available every year and prospective students are advised to check on the availability of specific courses. Students should also note there may be some restrictions on combining particular courses within their degree programme. Students wishing to take a course that does not appear in the list but is offered by the Faculty of History will need to get permission from the relevant Course Tutor. An application should then be made by the candidate's supervisor.

Authenticity and Replication

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The course is designed to give students exposure to a central issue of the visual arts in an explicitly inter-disciplinary and cross-cultural framework. It will use a series of case studies to explore the idea of 'the real' or 'the authentic' in both images and objects. The historical and geographical contexts to be addressed will range widely, from ancient Greece and Rome, to early modern China and to contemporary art, including works seen as genuine as well as works regarded as fraudulent. The course will make particularly extensive use of trips to museums to view actual objects and images.

French Painting 1880–1912

The course examines the development of Post-Impressionist painting between 1880 and 1912, at which point Cubism began to have a major impact on the thinking of French artists. Rather than tracing a history of styles or individuals, we consider how artistic practices were closely linked to contemporary developments. The rise of new forms of image distribution, including cinema, will be addressed, as well as the changing role of painting in the public sphere. The writings of artists and their contemporaries will be examined alongside recent art-historical work.

Medieval European Art

This course addresses two problems central to the history of art: the roots of artistic invention, and suitable methods for instructing on technique. During this period, young, would-be artists acted as assistants to a master painter in his workshop. With this type of training, what was the scope for originality, and how was stylistic change encouraged? These issues are brought into sharp focus by the changing visual culture of late-medieval Europe, between the twelfth and the fifteenth centuries. The available literature on these themes is rich, yet inconsistent: the course therefore addresses questions that are very much open.

Reception of Classical European Art

From the fourteenth century the discovery of classical antiquities inspired contemporary artists, some copied closely, some restored the ancient in a contemporary style, while others reinterpreted freely. The course focuses on sculpture, painting and architecture in Britain, with a selection of other European works. Sculpture is examined in life-size marble statues, and in miniature with porcelain figurines. Painting is studied through the designs painted on vases, particularly Athenian and South Italian. Architecture is examined through the ancient Greek temples that were excavated in the nineteenth century and also replicated in miniature for sale to travelers.

Women, Art and Culture in Early Modern Europe

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This course will explore the various roles played by women in the production and reception of art and architecture in fifteenth- to seventeenth-century Europe. After many decades of relative neglect, the significance of the way women contributed to the art and culture of Early Modern Europe has come to light. By drawing on this wealth of new research, the course will examine the careers of professional women artists working in Northern and Southern Europe. We also consider how famous women patrons, such as Isabella d'Este and Catherine de Medici, influenced the careers of artists and wider perceptions about art. Another topic that will be addressed is the representation of women in the visual arts, for example as sitters for state portraits and marriage paintings.

Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

1 Applicants to the department must have previously studied art history.

2 Students can choose two optional courses instead of the Theory and Methods course.

3 The course organisers had more problems collecting art objects from some historical periods than others.

4 The Theory and Methods course focuses on the way art is made and perceived.

5 Students will be able to do any of the optional courses that are listed.

6 Students may be able to take an unlisted course if they get the appropriate approval.

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Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Optional courses

AUTHENTICITY AND REPLICATION

- genuine art is studied in addition to that considered (7) _____
- art objects are studied in (8) _____

FRENCH PAINTING 1880–1912

- the course covers the period up to when (9) _____ started to be prominent
- the course looks at the connections between art and new developments such as (10) _____

MEDIEVAL EUROPEAN ART

- the course looks at two issues: artistic creativity and processes for teaching technique
- the course considers how artists could be original when taught by an expert in a (11) _____

RECEPTION OF CLASSICAL EUROPEAN ART

- life-sized and miniature sculpture is examined
- painting is examined by looking at the decoration of (12) _____
- architecture is assessed by studying 19th century models bought by (13) _____

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Reading Passage 2

Sleep – Who Needs It?

It appears that some animals can survive on remarkably little sleep – could this also be the case for humans?

As any new parent knows, the first months of an infant's life mean little sleep for the family. But humans have it easy compared to orcas, also known as killer whales. University of California, Los Angeles, neuroscientist Jerome Siegel and post-doctorate fellow Oleg Lyamin have found that for the first month after giving birth, killer whale mothers and their calves do not experience normal sleep at all, and neither stops moving for more than a few minutes at a time. 'These sleep patterns contrast with those of most other mammals, which need extra sleep during infancy and gradually sleep less as they age, while orcas are never as active as in the first months of life,' Siegel says. The young orcas' movement and wakefulness help them keep their body temperature constant until mass and blubber insulation develop and allow for frequent respiration. Meanwhile the mothers of newborn orcas must constantly look out for sharks, while teaching the calves to breathe.

According to Siegel, the results of his orca study fundamentally change our view of sleep. 'It has often been said that sleep is necessary for an animal's primary development, particularly that of the brain,' Siegel says. 'But here we have a creature which grows one of the largest brains in the animal kingdom, and yet it is doing this without sleep.' All mammals and birds appear to need sleep, but scientists are unsure if reptiles and fish do. 'When you come downstairs at three in the morning, the goldfish isn't lying on the bottom of the bowl, it's swimming around,' Siegel says. But other scientists believe fish do enter a restful dormant state that is at least similar to sleep.

Some animals die without proper sleep, and experiments have shown that sleep deprivation can cause death more quickly than food deprivation. Two weeks without sleep can kill laboratory rats. Sleep is clearly important, but what determines how much we sleep, and when? Siegel thinks that the sleep an animal needs is dictated less by biological functions than by the animal's environmental niche. Availability of food is a major factor. The long rest typical of bats, for example, helps the animals to economize on energy. 'If a bat eats insects for only three hours in the evening, then maybe the best thing is to go hang in a cave upside down for the rest of the day,' Siegel says.

Sleep is not the same for all creatures. In dolphins, half the brain may rest while the other half stays vigilantly awake, and the animal carries on everyday activities. Dolphins sleep literally with one eye closed – the eye on the opposite side of the body to the dozing brain hemisphere, since the right brain hemisphere works the left eye and vice versa. However, for unknown reasons, closed eyes seem to be a virtually universal prerequisite for sleep.

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Neuroscientist Clifford Saper of the Harvard Medical School has located a small area at the base of the brain called the ventrolateral preoptic nucleus that sends chemical signals to other parts of the brain during sleep to slow those brain parts down and determines the best sleep budget for the animal. It is flexible, able to reverse the normal nocturnal habits of a rodent to make it sleep at night, if day is the only time the rodent can find what it needs to eat. According to Saper, evidence suggests that for restoring tired muscles or any other body system, sleep is no more effective than a comparable period of wakeful resting – except for one critical organ, the brain. The human brain apparently cannot do without sleep. Studies show that prolonged wakefulness leads to degradation of memory, alertness, coordination and judgment.

Nevertheless, studies of species exhibiting 'natural models of sleep deprivation,' as psychologist Verner Bingman of Ohio's Bowling Green State University calls them, may allow researchers to provide us with new methods for adapting to limited sleep without losing effectiveness. 'We could live 20-hour lives instead of 12- or 14-hour lives,' says Bingman, who is studying the behavior of the migratory birds Swainson's thrushes, which for migration purposes, go from a normal night's sleep of 10 to 12 hours down to about 2.5 hours so they can fly at night. To handle the energy output of the long journey they must nearly double the amount of fat in their bodies. They have to switch from a diet of seeds to one of fruits and insects, which they must search for during the day, so further limiting their sleep time.

Bingman and doctoral student Thomas Fuchs have discovered that during morning and midday hours the thrushes enter phases of drowsiness, during which they take as many as 50 micro naps per hour, most of them lasting about 10 seconds. When brain waves are measured, these napping behaviors look very much like normal sleep. Says Bingman, 'The trick would be to develop techniques or drugs that could recreate a similar brain pattern in humans.' Saper, however, disagrees. 'The effect of 20 hours of wakefulness on driving is the equivalent of two shots of whiskey,' he warns. 'Sleep deprivation is unfortunately a major cause of death in the US in young adults, who have a very high crash rate between 3 and 6 am.' He thinks we are dreaming if we think we're ever going to get by on as little sleep as newborn orcas or migrating thrushes.

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Questions 14–17

Look at the following findings (Questions 14–17) and the list of researchers below. Match each finding with the correct researcher, **A, B or C**.

LIST OF RESEARCHERS

A Jerome Siegel

B Clifford Saper

C Verner Bingman

Q	Finding	Answer
14	Discovered a specific area of the brain that sends signals to help regulate an animal's sleep.	
15	Found that newborn animals of a certain species do not sleep normally for weeks after birth.	
16	Questioned the belief that sleep is essential for developing a large brain.	
17	Studied a species of bird that drastically reduces its sleep time for a particular purpose.	

Questions 18–23

Complete the summary below. Choose **ONE OR TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

Newborn orcas move almost constantly in their first weeks of life, which helps them regulate their (18) _____ before they develop enough blubber for insulation. During this period, orca mothers must remain alert to the danger of (19) _____. Sleep deprivation can be fatal: in laboratory studies, (20) _____ have died after being kept awake for two weeks. Despite the many differences between species, having (21) _____ appears to be a near-universal requirement for sleep. According to Saper, sleep may be essential only for the (22) _____, rather than for restoring other parts of the body. Migratory birds such as Swainson's thrushes drastically cut their sleep time in order to complete their (23) _____.

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Questions 24–26

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 2?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

24 According to Siegel, young orcas sleep less than most other newborn mammals.

25 Scientists are certain that fish experience genuine sleep.

26 Saper's research suggests that sleep is essential for restoring muscle tissue.

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Reading Passage 3

Looking at Daily Life in Ancient Rome

In this preface to a history, the writer explains the factors affecting the scope of his study

If our ideas on Roman life are not to become lost in confusion, we must study it within a strictly defined time. Nothing changes more rapidly than human customs. Looking at our own more familiar world, apart from the great scientific discoveries of recent centuries which have turned it upside down – steam, electricity, railways, motor cars, and aeroplanes, for example – it is clear that the elementary forms of everyday life have been subject to increasing change.

Potatoes, for example, were not introduced into Europe until the sixteenth century, coffee was first drunk there in the late sixteenth or early seventeenth, and the banana was used in desserts in Europe at the beginning of the twentieth. The law of change was not less operative in antiquity. It was a commonplace of Roman rhetoric to contrast the crude simplicity of the Republic (509 BC–27 BC) with the luxury and refinement of the imperial times which followed. There is no common measure, whether of home, or house, or furniture, between ages which are so different.

Since a choice of time must necessarily be made, this history will confine itself to studying the generation which was born about the middle of the first century AD, toward the end of the reign of Claudius (41–54 AD) or the beginning of the reign of Nero (54–68 AD), and which lived on into the reign of Trajan (98–117 AD) and of Hadrian (117–138 AD). This generation saw the Roman Empire at its most powerful and prosperous. It was witness to the last conquests of the Caesars: the conquest of Dacia, in modern-day Eastern Europe, which brought vast mineral wealth into the Empire, and the conquest of Arabia, which helped to bring the riches of India and East Asia flooding into Rome. In the material domain, this generation attained the pinnacle of ancient civilization.

By a fortunate coincidence – all the more fortunate in that Latin literature was soon to run nearly dry – this generation is the one whose records combine to offer us the most complete picture of Roman life that we possess. We have a profusion of vivid and picturesque descriptions, precise and colourful, in such works as the Epigrams of Martial, the Satires of Juvenal, and the Letters of Pliny.

In addition, the Forum of Trajan in Rome itself and the ruins of Herculaneum and Pompeii, the two prosperous resorts buried by the eruption of Mount Vesuvius in 79 AD, supply an immense fund of archaeological evidence. Later excavations have also restored to us the ruins of the city of Ostia, which date in the main from the time when the Emperor Hadrian created this great commercial city as a realization of his town planning ideas. Fortune has favoured the historian of this time.

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It is not enough to focus our study of Roman life only on a fixed time. It would lack foundation and consistency if we did not also focus it in space – in the country or in the town. Even today, when the facilities for communication bring something of the city into the smallest and most isolated country cottage, there remains a significant difference between rural existence and the excitement of city life: a much greater gulf separated the peasant from the townsman of antiquity.

So large was the inequality between them that, according to the historian Rostovtzeff, it pitted one against the other in a fierce and silent struggle which pierced the wall protecting the Roman privileged classes from the barbarian flood from the north. When the barbarian forces began to invade Roman territory, the peasants decided to fight alongside them.

The townsman, in fact, enjoyed all the goods and resources of the earth. The peasant knew nothing but unending labour without profit and was unable to enjoy the activities available in even the poorest of cities: the liveliness of the sports field, the warmth of the public baths, and the magnificence of public spectacles.

In a work on the history of everyday life, we must give up any attempt to blend two such dissimilar pictures into one and must choose between them. The time which we have chosen to describe day by day is that of those Roman subjects who spent their time exclusively in the town, or rather in The City, Rome, which they regarded as the hub and centre of the universe, proud and wealthy ruler of a world which seemed at that time to have been pacified forever.

To perform our task well, we must first try to form an adequate picture of the surroundings in which our subjects lived and by which their lives were coloured, freeing ourselves from any misconceptions concerning it. We must seek to reconstruct the physical nature of the great city and the social milieu of the various classes of the hierarchy by which it was governed. We must also investigate the moral background of thought and sentiment which can help explain both its strength and its weaknesses.

The way in which the Romans of Rome employed their time can only be studied satisfactorily after we have plotted out the main lines of the framework within which they lived and outside of which the routine of their daily life would be more or less unintelligible.

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Questions 27–30

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

27 What does the writer say about the period mentioned in the second paragraph?

A There was a high level of immigration into Rome.

B The export of minerals made Rome rich.

C Rome sent armies to control trade with India and East Asia.

D The Roman standard of living reached its highest level.

28 Ostia is mentioned as:

A a city which often features in literature.

B an important area for archaeological research.

C the birthplace of a Roman Emperor.

D a city whose layout was similar to that of Rome.

29 The statement that 'Fortune has favoured the historian of this time' refers to the fact that:

A historians of this period have become wealthy as a result of their discoveries.

B works on this period are popular among the reading public.

C a wide range of sources is available for this period.

D this period has been less studied than many others.

30 In comparing urban and rural life in the Roman Empire, the writer states that:

A rural Romans were largely illiterate.

B rural life and urban life had little in common.

C little information is available concerning rural life.

D most readers of history are more interested in city life.

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Questions 31–36

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

YES *if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer* • **NO** *if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer* • **NOT GIVEN** *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

31 Rome's conquest of Arabia resulted in large-scale immigration from the east into Rome.

32 More can be learned about Roman life from the literature of the period studied in this book than from later Latin literature.

33 Discoveries at Herculaneum and Pompeii showed that certain beliefs about Roman life were wrong.

34 Roman peasants provided assistance to the Empire when it was attacked.

35 Rural inhabitants of the Roman Empire had a difficult life.

36 Entertainment facilities were limited to the city of Rome itself.

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Questions 37–40

Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–I**, *below.*

The scope of the writer's study

WORD LIST

A emperors
B setting
C values
D peasants
E city-dwellers
F social classes
G myths
H period
I investigation

It was important for the writer to limit several aspects of his (37) _____. He decided to focus on a limited (38) _____ in Roman history and to concentrate on the section of the population who were (39) _____. The writer was interested in the physical environment, the people that ruled the country, and the (40) _____ that contributed both to Rome's strength and to its weaknesses.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 6

Volume 6 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Ambergris – What Is It and Where Does It Come From?

In the ancient world, the waxy grey substance we now refer to as ambergris was highly prized for its medicinal properties, and was widely used as a spice, which was believed to be an aphrodisiac when added to food or wine. Ambergris itself is pleasantly aromatic, especially when warmed, and it was also highly valued as a fixing agent in the making of perfume, since it enabled a scent to retain its fragrance for much longer than might otherwise have been possible. Most ambergris was found in the form of lumps floating on the surface of the sea, or washed up on the shores of tropical and temperate oceans. At one time, ambergris was worth its weight in gold, but there was much confusion about its origins.

Ambergris was known to the Arabs as 'ambar' and was originally called amber in the West in the Middle Ages. This eventually led to further confusion in the popular mind between ambergris and true amber, the mineral known to mineralogists as succinite, which is actually fossilised tree resin, and generally yellow in colour. Both substances were rare and costly, and both were associated with the sea, largely because for Europeans the most common source of amber was the shores of the Baltic. In Chapter 92 of Moby Dick, the American writer Herman Melville pours scorn on those who believed the two substances to be the same:

"Though the word ambergris is but the French compound for grey amber, yet the two substances are quite distinct. For amber, though at times found on the sea-coast, is also dug up in some far inland soils, whereas ambergris is never found except upon the sea. Besides, amber is a hard, transparent, brittle, odorless substance, used for mouth-pieces to pipes, for beads and ornaments; but ambergris is soft, waxy, and so highly fragrant that it is largely used in perfumery."

Moby Dick was published in 1851, by which time the mystery of the origins of ambergris had been resolved by the scientific community. In 1783, the botanist Joseph Banks, who had accompanied Captain James Cook on his voyages of discovery in the Pacific, presented a paper to the Royal Society of London by the German physician Dr. Franz Xavier Schwediawer in which it was conclusively proved that ambergris came from sperm whales. In this, he was confirming an observation made in the 13th century by the great Venetian traveller Marco Polo who, while on the island of Socotra in the Indian Ocean, had

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witnessed a sperm whale vomiting up ambergris. But whereas Marco Polo imagined that the whale had swallowed the lump in the depths of the sea, Schwediawer showed that the origin of the material was inside the whale itself.

The sperm whale is the largest of the odontocetes, or toothed whales. Males can grow up to 20 meters in length. Melville described the sperm whale as the 'king of whales', and his novel Moby Dick is based on the pursuit of one such creature. Sperm whales are renowned for their ability to dive to great depths, possibly as far as 3,000 metres below the surface, and for remaining underwater for periods of two hours or more in pursuit of their favourite prey, the giant squid.

It is from the problems the whales have in digesting the beaks of such creatures that ambergris has its origins. The beak is sharp and irritates the whale's lower intestine, which responds by producing a black, foul-smelling liquid. It is not clear to scientists whether this secretion should be considered a normal response by the whale's digestive system or a pathological one, but from time to time large quantities of the liquid are vomited up by the whale. Once outside the whale's body and exposed to air, the substance hardens, acquiring the waxy, greyish and pleasantly aromatic characteristics of ambergris. Often the beaks of squid are still found embedded in lumps of ambergris, some of which can weigh several hundred kilograms. Melville took some delight in contrasting the origins of ambergris with the high value placed upon it by refined society:

"Who would think, then, that such fine ladies and gentlemen should regale themselves with an essence found in the inglorious bowels of a sick whale!"

Sperm whales were ruthlessly pursued by commercial whalers in the 19th and 20th centuries. In 1963–64 alone, almost 30,000 individuals were killed, and only the imposition of a ban on the hunting of sperm whales in 1984 saved the species from extinction. Ambergris was by far the most valuable product to be extracted during the processing of the whales' carcasses, and over 90 per cent of the annual worldwide total was acquired in this way, as a by-product of commercial whaling. However, even before the ban on hunting sperm whales was imposed, the 1972 Marine Mammal Protection Act had prohibited trade in ambergris. Just as petroleum and plastic products were replacing other natural products of whaling, so ambergris was supplanted in the making of perfume by other materials, some natural and some synthetic in origin. Nevertheless, it is possible that, as sperm whale populations recover to their former numbers in the wild, so the sight of lumps of ambergris washed ashore along the tide line will once again become a familiar one to beachcombers the world over.

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Questions 1–6

According to the information in Reading Passage 1, classify the following facts as referring to:

CLASSIFICATION

A ambergris only
B amber only
C both ambergris and amber
D neither ambergris nor amber

Q	Fact	Answer
1	very expensive	
2	a food flavouring	
3	used as currency	
4	sweet-smelling	
5	referred to by Herman Melville	
6	can be seen through	

Questions 7–9

Complete the flow-chart below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

How ambergris is formed

Ambergris is formed in whales because of problems digesting the (7) ——— of giant squid.

↓

Black liquid is produced and is (8) ——— from time to time.

↓

The liquid (9) ——— on contact with the air.

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Questions 10–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

10 In the 20th century, most of the world's ambergris came from processing dead whales.

11 The value of ambergris has increased recently.

12 Ambergris remains an important ingredient in perfume.

13 New uses have recently been found for ambergris.

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Reading Passage 2

Photography

Photography emerged as part of a cluster of technical inventions and innovations around the middle of the nineteenth century. Hailed as a great technological invention, it immediately became the subject of debates concerning its aesthetic status and social uses.

A Central to the nineteenth-century debate about the nature of photography as a new technology was the question as to how far it could be considered as art. It was celebrated for its putative ability to produce accurate images of what was in front of the camera's lens: images which were seen as being mechanically produced and thus free of the selective discriminations of the human eye and hand. On precisely the same grounds, the medium was often regarded as falling outside the realm of art as its assumed power of accurate, dispassionate recording appeared to leave no room for the artist's compositional creativity.

B Debates concerning the status of photography as art continued to take place in periodicals throughout the nineteenth century. The French poet Baudelaire linked these discussions to his hostility against the general trend towards realism, arguing that if photography is allowed to develop to the detriment of art, it will bring about the loss to human spiritual content. According to this view, photography's function was to support intellectual endeavors.

C Baudelaire was not alone in this view. Absolute material accuracy was seen as the hallmark of photography, and the nineteenth-century debates, recounted in the catalogues of human experience, both at home and overseas, encouraged people to emphasize photography as a method of naturalistic documentation.

D Photographers responded to criticisms of this kind in two ways: either they accepted that photography was something different from art and sought to discover what the inherent properties of the medium were, or they pointed out that photography was more than a mechanical form of image-making, that it could be worked on and contrived so as to produce pictures which in some ways resembled paintings. From the 1880s onwards, pictorial photographers sought to overcome the problems of photography by careful arrangement of all the elements of the composition and by reducing the signs of its technological production. For example, they made pictures of allegorical subjects, including religious scenes, ensuring that the image was somewhat blurred, and those who worked with the gum bichromate process scratched their prints in an effort to imitate something of the appearance of a canvas.

E In the other camp were those photographers who celebrated the qualities of straight photography (with an emphasis upon direct documentary typical of the Modern period in American photography) and did not want to treat the medium as a kind of monochrome

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painting. They were interested in photography's ability to provide apparently accurate records of the visual world and tried to give their images the formal status and finish of paintings while concentrating their attention on its intrinsic quality.

F Photography in Britain and France was initially heralded for its technical recording abilities. With few exceptions, the emphasis was on picture-taking rather than picture-making, echoing a distinction made by Margaret Harker. She suggests that the development of the art of photography in the late 1850s can be partly accounted for through the increasing involvement of people trained as artists. They brought with them a concern for form and composition and, in particular, the use of light. Photography came to record everyday life on terms of painting, such as portraiture, not only taking over some of the work of painters but also setting their work free. For instance, while recording for detail was still a strong part of a painted portrait, the studio portrait could now be created more cheaply. As such, portraiture became more democratically available. This not only prevented certain cultural groups from claiming exclusivity of the art of recording appearances but also provided access to a much greater number of people to this subtly sensed idea. This did not prevent a continuing hierarchy, however: the painted portrait was still commissioned by the wealthy and the aristocracy.

G Furthermore, photography provoked artists to re-examine the nature and role of their art and to seek new forms of expression more attuned to an industrialized society. It had a sense of instantaneousness that painting lacked, and it has been suggested that this quality encouraged Impressionist painters to experiment with ways of capturing a fleeting moment and the changing effects of light. It is a truism that photography released painting from its responsibility for literal depiction, allowing it to become more experimental. The division between mechanical and artistic reproduction shaped the nineteenth-century relationship between photography and art.

H In the early days of photography, museums often displayed photos in rooms dedicated to scientific and industrial subjects. People were now able to see reproductions of famous works of art, leading to the development of art books, and, in architecture or sculpture, you could visit an exhibition and view reproductions.

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Questions 14–17

Reading Passage 2 has eight paragraphs, **A–H**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?*

Q	Information	Answer
14	fears voiced about the potential threat posed to art by photography	
15	the skills of artists being used in photography	
16	the attempts of photographers to imitate art	
17	the influence of photography on artists and painting	

Questions 18–22

Complete the summary of paragraphs D and E below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from paragraph D or E for each answer.*

Photographers' responses to criticism

In response to the suggestion that photography could not be considered an art form, photographers acted in two ways. Some of them rejected this criticism, certain that they could create pictures similar to (18) _____ and did this by carefully setting up the different parts of the (19) _____ before taking the photograph. Other things they did included causing the picture to be rather (20) _____ and some who wanted to try to make the print look like a canvas even (21) _____ their photographs. Others were anxious that their work should not be looked upon as some sort of (22) _____ painting and were much more concerned with the fact that the camera seemed to be able to produce a more accurate representation of what they could see around them.

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Questions 23–26

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 2?

TRUE *if the statement agrees with the information* • **FALSE** *if the statement contradicts the information* • **NOT GIVEN** *if there is no information on this*

23 The increasing involvement of artists helped develop the art of photography.

24 Photography made portrait painting completely obsolete.

25 Painted portraits stopped being commissioned by wealthy clients in the 19th century.

26 Photography allowed painting to explore more creative and experimental approaches.

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Reading Passage 3

The Long View

Climate change, moon bases, cybercrime: we all know the predictions, but how are they made? One expert explains the science of futurology

The business of predicting the future has a long history. Several millennia ago in ancient Greece, people would consult Apollo, the god of prophecy, to learn if fortune favoured their chosen course of action. The tradition has changed considerably since then. Today, futurology is a science that drives a thriving business – its three main consumers being the military, big business and national governments. Modern futurists do not predict that a certain event will occur at a particular time. Instead they look at what is happening now to see what this may lead to further down the line. Alternatively, they start with a desired result and work out how people and organisations can be manoeuvred into realising that ambition.

The oil company Shell has been one of the major producers of future studies. It recently published a comprehensive study looking at how people may live in 2020 and 2050, given the type of energy which is purchased. Philip Watts from Shell says, 'This is not an exercise in prophecy. Rather it is designed to challenge our thinking so that we can make better choices in today's business world.'

The short-term attitudes and bureaucracy of many governments can be frustrating to futurists, but this mutual wariness is slowly changing. The Scottish Parliament recently hosted a conference of 150 futurists from across the globe. The parliament is setting up a forum to look at where Scotland is heading in the next 20 years. Among the issues are demographics and economic competition within Europe and with Asia. It's a first for the United Kingdom, although not for Europe – this strategy has already been put into practice in Finland.

Eamonn Kelly, head of the San Francisco-based Global Business Network futurist group, was one of those who attended the conference. According to Kelly, 'There are many different tools a futurist can employ but essentially there are three main ingredients. First, there is the "science", which can encompass everything from environmental studies to psychology. Then, there is the "craft", which may include interviews and the creation of maps of cause and effect. Finally, there is the "art", the intuitive ability to meld all this into a coherent whole.'

Dr James Canton is founder of the San Francisco-based Institute for Global Futures and has been an adviser to leading US companies. Like many futurists he started in the private sector but is also comfortable in academia and has an urge to change things for the better. 'A futurist is an alchemist who mixes the qualitative and the quantitative,' he says. 'He

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needs intuition and has to work with people from a range of academic backgrounds gathering primary evidence about what motivates people. Futurists are constantly discussing ideas with their peers, but they do not simply surf the net picking up on the latest fad.'

New Zealand futurist Robin Gunston says, 'I don't believe you can train yourself to become a futurist. A certain amount of this is to do with how your brain is hard-wired and we know this is difficult to change. Futurology requires extensive life experience and a broad education to test theories against. Much of modern teenage culture is about me, what I want and what the world owes me – that does not make it easy to see different kinds of futures and pose the hard questions about how we will get there.'

Those best able to respond to futurists are the most agile. 'Large corporations beholden to shareholders and governments burdened by bureaucracy are often simply too slow. Asian companies tend to be better prepared because they take a longer perspective. Sony, for example, is very forward looking,' Canton says. 'There will be sunset and sunrise nations and corporations, in terms of prosperity in the 21st century. The winners will be those corporations and governments which conduct future studies and take steps to become future-proofed.'

According to Alan Beckley, a former West Mercia chief inspector and past president of the Police Futurists International (PFI), getting public bodies in the UK future-proofed could be a long process. 'People are concerned about the methodology and the reliability of future studies,' he says. 'They are more likely to follow their political masters than go to them and say, "We have done this scenario, and this is what we should do".' However, as the Scottish Parliament has shown, there are a few examples of government exercises. Also, in 2003 Britain's Foreign and Commonwealth Office (FCO) published for the first time its strategic thinking for the next decade. This document was drawn up with the help of in-house and outside futurists. FCO minister Bill Rammell says, 'We do occasionally look further ahead than the next ten years on issues such as demographics. But the period chosen for the strategy was deliberately a decade. Even assumptions about technology get very shaky beyond that.'

American futurist Steve Brant stresses the importance of remembering that the road ahead has yet to be chosen. 'People can create the future they want using various points of leverage,' he says. 'We have much more influence over what the future will be like than many of us realise.' Futurists used to be like firefighters – they tried to work out what to do if things went wrong. Now, the aim of this profession is to imagine the best possible future for society and start creating it today.

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Questions 27–33

Look at the following statements (Questions 27–33) and the list of people below. Match each statement with the correct person, **A–F**. *You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF PEOPLE

A Philip Watts
B Dr James Canton
C Robin Gunston
D Alan Beckley
E Bill Rammell
F Steve Brant

Q	Statement	Answer
27	Flexible organisations are in a better position to make use of futurology	
28	Predictions about any period beyond the next ten years cannot be trusted	
29	Only certain people are suited to becoming futurists	
30	Future studies are designed to inform current commercial decisions	
31	Futurology involves a broad exchange of information but is not influenced by every new idea	
32	People are not aware of the extent to which they can determine the future	
33	A lack of confidence in futurology affects how widely it is used	

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Questions 34–37

Complete the sentences below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

A report by Shell considered the impact of various kinds of (34) _____ on future lifestyles.

The Scottish parliament has decided to use futurists to advise on (35) _____ from Asian and other European countries.

Dr James Canton is similar to other futurists in that he began his career in the (36) _____.

Britain's FCO sometimes studies developments in areas like (37) _____ beyond 10 years.

Questions 38–40

Choose **THREE** *letters,* **A–G**. *Which THREE of the following statements are true according to the passage?*

A Present-day futurology can focus on achieving a particular outcome
B Futurists recognise that most governments have already made long-term plans
C The world's first futurology conference was hosted by Finland
D Futurists need to talk to people from various areas of expertise
E Futurists should carry out internet research to keep up with popular trends
F Aspects of modern culture prepare people well for a career in futurology
G Conducting future studies can affect whether a company continues to be successful

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PART TWO

Answer Keys

Complete answer keys for Tests 1–6 of Volume 6. Check your answers only after finishing each test.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 1 (Volume 6)

Passage 1 — Mungo Lady and Mungo Man

1. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	ancestors not from one area
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Thorne is "the country's leading opponent of the **'Out of Africa' theory**" — his DNA study "supported his idea that modern humans developed from archaic humans **in several places around the world**."

2. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	megafauna extinction was brief
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Roberts and Flannery "argu[ed] that their analysis showed that the megafauna died out **suddenly** 46,600 years ago."

3. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	megafauna died from human activity
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Flannery is "a proponent of the controversial theory that these animals were **wiped out by the extreme hunting practices of humans**."

4. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	similar results not always valid
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Grün: "the fact that the latest results were **consistent between laboratories doesn't mean they are correct**."

5. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	Mungo Man's age unimportant
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Thorne: "the age of Mungo Man is **irrelevant**... It doesn't matter if he is 40,000 or 60,000 years old."

6. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	evidence against mass extinction
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Field and Fullager "point to the presence of megafauna fossils at the **36,000-year-old Cuddie Springs site**," which contradicts the sudden-extinction date.

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7. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	extreme change when humans arrived
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Bowler "argues that **climate change 40,000 years ago was more intense** than has been previously realised" (contrasted with Flannery, who says there was no such evidence).

8. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	earliest evidence of advanced culture
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Bowler: Mungo Man and Lady "remain Australia's oldest human burials and **the earliest evidence on Earth of cultural sophistication**."

9. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	objects used to date arrival
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"families... leav[ed] artefacts such as **stone tools, which researchers used to determine** that the first wanderers came to the area between 46,000 and 50,000 years ago."

10. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	ancient weapons found
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	only "stone tools" are mentioned as artefacts; weapons are not discussed

11. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	scientists agree on age
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Bowler's 40,000-year finding is "**much younger than the 62,000 years**" Thorne's team attributed — an ongoing dispute, not agreement.

12. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Thorne used more than one material
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Thorne's team used **three techniques** to date Mungo Man – bone, tooth enamel and sand."

13. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Bowler criticised Thorne's methods

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Bowler has **strongly challenged the results** ever since. Dating human bones is 'notoriously unreliable,' he says."

Passage 2 — The Attraction of Video Games

14. vi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Designing video games is increasingly recognised as a valid field of **university study**" — the growth of the industry/training.

15. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an effective learning environment is one in which **failure is acceptable**, even welcomed."

16. vii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the player's **ability to determine what happens**. Games tap into our need to have direction."

17. iii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"you need those **occasional surprises** to stay motivated."

18. ii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"incorporating a **narrative structure** into a game is becoming increasingly important."

19. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for section F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the new concept of **'gamification'**, in which websites and smartphone apps are being designed like games."

20. D — Dan Pinchbeck

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QUESTION KEYWORD	players think ahead
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"There's an emphasis on the **pleasure of choosing and planning**."

21. E — Ben Weedon

QUESTION KEYWORD	surprises keep players interested
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"you need those **occasional surprises** to stay motivated."

22. A — Jesper Juul

QUESTION KEYWORD	game design now a learnable skill
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Designing video games is increasingly recognised as a **valid field of university study**."

23. D — Dan Pinchbeck

QUESTION KEYWORD	early games were simpler
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"We've moved quite dramatically away from the **very first video games**," which "mostly involved the player merely reacting to events."

24. failure

QUESTION KEYWORD	fear of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an effective learning environment is one in which **failure** is acceptable, even welcomed."

25. disapproval

QUESTION KEYWORD	excitement from ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the vague sense of **disapproval** that still surrounds them – they feel like something that's forbidden!"

26. short

QUESTION KEYWORD	first/last part are ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a **short** final act is often used... Opening levels of games are also **short**."

Passage 3 — Blind to Change

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27. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	main topic
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the passage as a whole discusses change blindness — **limitations of human perception and attention**.

28. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	what Simons' experiment demonstrates
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"found that 50% of participants missed the substitution because of what is called **change blindness**."

29. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	result of basketball experiment
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a man in a gorilla suit walked through the scene, yet **many participants failed to notice him**."

30. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	what participants failed to notice
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the man who initially approached you walked off behind the door... **The first man now rejoins you**" — the substitution of the person.

31. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	what change blindness suggests
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"this phenomenon suggests we **see far less than we think we do**."

32. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	what basketball experiment revealed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"attention can be so narrowly focused on a specific task that we **become blind to other**, seemingly obvious, changes."

33. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	why eyewitness testimony unreliable
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"individuals often **do not register all the details** of an event, especially if their attention was focused elsewhere."

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34. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	researchers always believed full detail
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**Until recently**, researchers thought that seeing involved making pictures in the brain" — not "always," and now revised.

35. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Dennett: brains store detailed pictures
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Dennett "claimed that our brains hold **only a few salient details** about the world."

36. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	testimonies completely reliable
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Eyewitness testimonies... **may be unreliable** because individuals often do not register all the details."

37. D — Daniel Simons

QUESTION KEYWORD	50% missed a change in a person
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Daniel Simons of Harvard University found that **50% of participants missed the substitution**."

38. A — Daniel Dennett

QUESTION KEYWORD	brain holds few details
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Dennett "claimed that our brains hold **only a few salient details** about the world."

39. B — Christopher Chabris

QUESTION KEYWORD	conducted basketball/gorilla experiment
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Christopher Chabris, **who worked with Simons on the gorilla experiment**."

40. C — John Grimes

QUESTION KEYWORD	change blindness during eye movements
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Grimes showed people "fail to notice significant changes made to a scene **during a saccade**, the rapid eye movement."

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 2 (Volume 6)

Passage 1 — The World's First Cities

1. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	physical evidence still exists
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"There is not much left now of Uruk... but **enough does remain** to show that this initial experiment in urban living was extraordinarily successful."

2. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	lived in large apartment buildings
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the people of Uruk built "a dozen or so **large public buildings**" — communal/religious structures, not residential apartment blocks.

3. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	builders experimented with methods
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"often trying out a **different building material or an innovative technique**."

4. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	urban settlements unusual
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"By about 4,500 years ago, **80 per cent** of the Mesopotamian population lived in cities."

5. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	rivers important for exchange of ideas
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the rivers were "the basis of a **communication system that led to the spread of the latest concepts** in farming."

6. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	farmers relied on relatives
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	famine "forced people to **look outside their families**, and work with their neighbours."

7. surplus

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QUESTION KEYWORD	food ____ as insurance
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"generated a **surplus** of food, allowing crops... to be stored as protection."

8. pyramids

QUESTION KEYWORD	shape of large ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"temple structures were erected in the form of massive **pyramids**."

9. storerooms

QUESTION KEYWORD	large ____ where produce kept
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	pyramids "had enormous **storerooms** for the output from the farming estates."

10. staff

QUESTION KEYWORD	needed ____ to manage farms
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	temples "appointed a large number of **staff** to administer them."

11. banks

QUESTION KEYWORD	acted as ____ in hard times
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	temples could "serve as primitive kinds of **banks**, making loans to people in difficult economic times."

12. clay

QUESTION KEYWORD	surfaces made of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"basic records were inscribed in wet **clay**."

13. fires

QUESTION KEYWORD	undamaged after ____ in archives
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **fires** that often burnt down the archives... usually merely baked them for future generations."

Passage 2 — Australia's Camouflaged Creatures

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14. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	signals young to less visible place
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	tawny frogmouth (Section C): "their **parents try to signal to them to move to a safe location**."

15. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	sound helps escape
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	chameleon gecko (Section G): "the tail bones actually rub against one another, so it **squeaks**."

16. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	matches range of backgrounds
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	cuttlefish (Section D): "can almost instantly **change its colour, pattern and texture to match its surroundings**."

17. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	majority of animals disguise
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Section A: "**Most species use camouflage** to some extent."

18. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	animals that look like plants
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Section B: stick and leaf insects "**imitate living foliage**, even the veins in a leaf."

19. C — Professor Gisela Kaplan

QUESTION KEYWORD	tactic not present from birth
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the ability to choose a backdrop… **does not develop for 4–6 months**."

20. B — Paul Zborowski

QUESTION KEYWORD	ancient environment, very effective
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"It's an **incredibly old habitat** so the creatures have had a long time to adapt."

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21. F — Martyn Robinson

QUESTION KEYWORD	part of animal left behind
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the chameleon gecko will **drop off its tail**, which will wriggle around on the ground."

22. A — Professor Mark Elgar

QUESTION KEYWORD	look for alternative prey
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the predator will simply **target another species**."

23. E — Henry Bates

QUESTION KEYWORD	copying a threatening animal
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Batesian mimicry: "animals that gain protection... by **imitating a dangerous organism**," named after Bates.

24. reefs

QUESTION KEYWORD	studies fangblenny on ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"On Queensland's **reefs**, scientists have been studying another ocean dweller."

25. parasites

QUESTION KEYWORD	wrasse removes their ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	cleaner wrasse "eats the **parasites** on larger fish."

26. prey

QUESTION KEYWORD	approach its ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the disguise also lets it get closer to **prey**."

Passage 3 — The Effectiveness of an Online Course

27. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	classroom-based learning element

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The ability to ask a question, to share an opinion... or to **disagree**" — the exchange of ideas.

28. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	Ruberg/Taylor/Moore requirement
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	web-based learning "can have **multiple threads with several discussions... progressing simultaneously**."

29. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	Sproull/Kiesler problem
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an instructor cannot necessarily **immediately correct or clarify** a comment."

30. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	concept of online presence
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'presence', or a **sense of being in a place and belonging to a group**."

31. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	focus of Picciano's study
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"go beyond student perceptions to include **performance** and perceptions of social presence."

32. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	ability to meet needs unclear
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the effectiveness of online courses... is **sometimes questioned**."

33. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	caution against online relationships
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the passage never advises against forming online relationships

34. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	face-to-face assumptions proved correct

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"However, this is **an assumption and not always true**."

35. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	meaning of presence still clarified
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the definition is **expanding and being refined**."

36. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	consistent results on interaction/outcomes
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the relationship of actual measures of interaction and performance is **mixed**."

37. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	ability to succeed online
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"students must adjust to the **nonlinear nature** of web-based learning."

38. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	mindful of comment source
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"students need to have the experience and knowledge base to **sift through the discussion for misinformation**."

39. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	presence rather than interaction
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	presence refers to "a student's sense of **being registered and belonging** in a course."

40. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	interaction/achievement relationship
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"how interaction affects learning outcomes... is **in need of further study**."

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 3 (Volume 6)

Passage 1 — The Growth of Agriculture

1. following

QUESTION KEYWORD	collected plants and ____ to get meat
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	nomadic people spent their lives "searching for food, **following** animal migrations and gathering wild plants."

2. cereals

QUESTION KEYWORD	probably ____, e.g. rice or corn
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The earliest crop was most likely to have been rice, corn, or similar types of **cereals**."

3. surplus

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ led to exchange of goods
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"produce a **surplus** of food which could be eaten... or swapped for other goods."

4. civilisations

QUESTION KEYWORD	growth of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"cities emerged, and eventually **civilisations** arose."

5. tools

QUESTION KEYWORD	better ____ from different materials
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"improved farming **tools** of bone, stone, bronze, and iron were developed."

6. water

QUESTION KEYWORD	systems providing supply of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"simple irrigation systems. By channelling **water** from streams onto their fields."

7. 2,000 (2000)

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QUESTION KEYWORD	____ years ago, dependent on farming
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"By **2,000 years** ago, much of the Earth's population was reliant on agriculture."

8. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Romans adapted own methods for Africa/Asia
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the Romans **adapted the best agricultural methods of the people they conquered**" — the reverse direction.

9. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	crops growing continually in all fields
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"one field... in spring, another in autumn, and one would be **left unplanted, or fallow**."

10. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	eating habits changed due to exploration
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	potatoes, tomatoes, maize and beans "eventually became staple crops and **an integral part of the European diet**."

11. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	countries created own seed drill versions
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	only that "seed drilling was **widely practiced** in many countries" — not whether each created its own version

12. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	selective breeding, more animals
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	farmers "increased both the **size of their herds** and the productivity of their livestock."

13. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	continued natural fertiliser after chemical
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	describes the shift to chemical fertilisers but not whether natural methods continued alongside them

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Passage 2 — The Aerofoil

14. v

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph A
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"our... brains tell us that because air is invisible it must be insubstantial too. **But air is not nothing**."

15. iii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph B
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it is worth carrying out an **experiment with knives and spoons** under a running tap."

16. iv

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph C
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"its **angle of attack**. The steeper the angle, the greater the lift."

17. vii

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph D
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"At the ends of the wings are **flaps**, which can be swung up or down."

18. i

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph E
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Ibn-Firnas "strap[ped] artificial wings to their arms and **leap[t] from high places**."

19. vi

QUESTION KEYWORD	heading for paragraph F
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Cayley "developed the names of the **key forces involved in flight** – lift, drag and thrust."

20. lift

QUESTION KEYWORD	curve provides maximum ___

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the thin curved wing shape "gives excellent **lift** for a light aircraft or a bird."

21. teardrop

QUESTION KEYWORD	look like a thin ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the wings of most large planes are, in profile, the shape of a narrow **teardrop**."

22. fuel

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ kept inside each wing
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **fuel** needed to power a flight is stored inside each wing."

23. flaps

QUESTION KEYWORD	pilot can adjust the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**flaps**, which can be swung up or down to alter the aerofoil's curvature."

24. ends

QUESTION KEYWORD	flaps at the ____ of the wings
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"At the **ends** of the wings are flaps."

25. & 26. C & E

QUESTION KEYWORD	what writer states about Cayley
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"carried out numerous **experiments** to establish what shapes and angles produced the **greatest lift**" [C & E].

Passage 3 — Looking for Inspiration

27. D — Jordan Peterson

QUESTION KEYWORD	receptive to immense information
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the brains of creative people are **more open to incoming stimuli**" — latent inhibition.

28. F — Guy Claxton

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QUESTION KEYWORD	numerous brain parts active at once
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Creative synthesis requires a new pattern, to put the brain in a state where **many areas are simultaneously active**."

29. B — Mark Runco

QUESTION KEYWORD	wide range of subjects
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the creative personality... have[s] **broad interests**, providing lots of resources to draw on."

30. C — Kay Redfield Jamison

QUESTION KEYWORD	unstable personalities
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"established artists are significantly more likely to have **mood disorders**."

31. B — Mark Runco

QUESTION KEYWORD	driven to achieve goals
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"highly self-motivated... when it comes to **realising their ambitions**."

32. G — Vera John-Steiner

QUESTION KEYWORD	need support from others
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"you need **strong social networks and trusting relationships**, not just active neural networks."

33. (scalp) electrodes

QUESTION KEYWORD	placed on volunteers' heads
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"used a network of scalp **electrodes** to record the pattern of brain waves."

34. inspiration

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ and elaboration phases
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"creativity, he showed, has two stages: **inspiration** and elaboration."

35. alpha waves

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QUESTION KEYWORD	brain inactive except for ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The dominant activity was **alpha waves**."

36. difference

QUESTION KEYWORD	greatest ____ in brain activity
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the people who showed the biggest **difference** in brain activity between the two stages... produced the most creative storylines."

37. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	very high IQ more likely creative
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"having beyond a certain level of IQ **does not help boost creativity**."

38. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	society values aesthetic skills
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the passage says creative individuals value aesthetic qualities, not that society at large does

39. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	disadvantages to creative personality
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"there may be a **price to pay** for having a creative personality... link... between creativity and mental illness."

40. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	language more important than spatial awareness
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"active areas are determined by the **specialist knowledge being used**" — depends on the skill, not universally language.

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 4 (Volume 6)

Passage 1 — Radiocarbon Dating: The Profile of Nancy Athfield

1. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Nancy first discovered the remains
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Many prehistoric remains were discovered **by the local people** of Cambodia."

2. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	remains in good condition
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the passage never describes the physical condition of the remains

3. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	took time off from regular work
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the passage doesn't state whether the Cambodia trip was separate from or part of her regular work

4. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	government asked Nancy to date remains
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the opportunity came because her **team of scientists and filmmakers** were making a documentary — no government request is mentioned.

5. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	filmmakers wanted to know how Angkor was rebuilt
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the team aimed to prove "that Cambodia was the **resting place** for the famous royal family," not how it was rebuilt.

6. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Nancy initially doubted the location
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	her personal opinion before the research is never mentioned

7. TRUE

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QUESTION KEYWORD	disproved royal family possibility
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Angkor's history "went back to as early as 1620," while "the remains of the Angkor royal family were much younger... this evidence **cast a lot of doubt**."

8. university

QUESTION KEYWORD	wasn't expected to attend ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"her friend suggested that Athfield invest in getting a degree... attend a nearby **university**," despite doubting her own qualifications.

9. rat

QUESTION KEYWORD	PhD examined a kind of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"completed her studies on a kind of **rat** when it first appeared in New Zealand."

10. diet

QUESTION KEYWORD	subject's ____ caused the fault
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Her research showed that the subject's **diet** led to the fault in the earlier research."

11. archaeologist

QUESTION KEYWORD	professional ____ before 2003
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Athfield eventually joined the field of anthropology... and became a well-qualified **archaeologist**."

12. funding

QUESTION KEYWORD	lack of ____ a barrier
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Her research was often delayed by lack of **funding**, and government paperwork."

13. database

QUESTION KEYWORD	compiled the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Athfield completed a **database** for the materials found in Cambodia."

Passage 2 — How Sleep Helps Us Learn

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14. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	sleep helps infants retain details
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Paragraph C: "sleep permits infants to **retain more of the redundant details** of a learning experience."

15. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	young vs older adult consolidation
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Paragraph F: "**Unlike young adults**, who solidify all the information... older people consolidate" only tagged experiences.

16. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	sleep deprivation, genetic disorder, language
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Paragraph D: Down's syndrome study found "**large differences in language knowledge**."

17. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	role of hippocampus
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Paragraph B: "transfer daytime memories from... the **hippocampus** into long-term storage."

18. E

QUESTION KEYWORD	overnight sleep more effective
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Paragraph E: "**Overnight sleep might be even better**, if the motor skills... are taught late enough in the day."

19. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	real-world application
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Paragraph G: "an **immediate real-world application**," Duffy says.

20. same

QUESTION KEYWORD	not as much ____ benefit
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	older adults "didn't seem to experience the **same** benefit."

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21. age

QUESTION KEYWORD	person's ____ made a difference
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Spencer wondered if **age** altered the relationship between sleep and memory."

22. preschool

QUESTION KEYWORD	experiment on children at the ____ stage
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"chose nearby **preschool** children as subjects."

23. interference

QUESTION KEYWORD	higher level of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"By staying awake, they have more **interference** from daytime experiences."

24. C — Jamie Edgin

QUESTION KEYWORD	sleep and vocabulary acquisition
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	studied Down's syndrome children, finding differences "in **language knowledge**."

25. D — Maria Korman

QUESTION KEYWORD	sleep and physical actions
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a nap soon after learning can allow the elderly to retain **procedural memories**."

26. B — Rebecca Gómez

QUESTION KEYWORD	young brain structure and memory
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the **hippocampus isn't yet fully developed**" in infants younger than 18 months.

Passage 3 — Petrol Power: An Eco-Revolution?

27. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	why De Smet in danger of starvation
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the snow was "**immobilising the railways** and cutting off the settlers."

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28. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	subsistence farmers' problem
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the 'lean season' – the **period of greatest scarcity** before the new crops became available."

29. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	use of coal
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	petroleum "displaced coal because of their **higher energy density, cleaner combustion** and greater ease of extraction."

30. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	1898 conference reference
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the horse-manure crisis was later resolved once cars replaced horses — **a problem solved by modern technology**.

31. H — unpleasant smells

QUESTION KEYWORD	led to certain ____ in streets
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"manure heaps created **unpleasant smells**."

32. J — diseases

QUESTION KEYWORD	linked to spread of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"contributing to the spread of **diseases** such as cholera and dysentery."

33. B — injuries

QUESTION KEYWORD	horses might cause ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"could easily **injure** pedestrians in the crowded streets."

34. E — environment

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ damaged in the countryside
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"considerable negative effects on the wider **environment**."

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35. C — food

QUESTION KEYWORD	need to provide ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"oats and hay to feed urban workhorses" — **food**.

36. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	poor-land farmers failed to benefit
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	modern transportation "allowed more suitable crops to be grown in the **poorer soils of Europe**."

37. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	positive effects in France 1830–1960
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"France benefited from an **expansion of its forest area** by one third."

38. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	fairer water distribution needed
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the passage discusses preventing depletion, not a call for fairer distribution

39. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	countryside less harmful than city
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Glaeser: "living in a concrete jungle is actually **far more ecologically friendly**" than residing in a forest.

40. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	transport largely positive
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"modern transportation technologies have been a **major contributor to a wealthier, cleaner and more sustainable world**."

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 5 (Volume 6)

Passage 1 — Studies in the History of Art and Visual Culture

1. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	must have studied art history before
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"do not require students to have a **first degree in art history**."

2. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	two options instead of Theory and Methods
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Theory and Methods is "**compulsory**," and students take two optional courses **in addition**.

3. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	more difficulty collecting some periods' objects
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the passage never compares the difficulty of sourcing objects across periods

4. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	focuses on how art is made/perceived
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"issues that relate to the **production of art and people's responses to it**."

5. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	able to do any listed course
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	courses "are **not available every year**" and there are "**restrictions on combining**" certain courses.

6. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	unlisted course with approval
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"will need to get **permission from the relevant Course Tutor**."

7. fraudulent

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QUESTION KEYWORD	genuine art alongside that considered ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"works seen as genuine as well as works regarded as **fraudulent**."

8. museums

QUESTION KEYWORD	art objects studied in ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"extensive use of trips to **museums** to view actual objects."

9. Cubism

QUESTION KEYWORD	up to when ____ became prominent
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"1880 and 1912, at which point **Cubism** began to have a major impact."

10. cinema

QUESTION KEYWORD	new developments such as ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"new forms of image distribution, including **cinema**."

11. workshop

QUESTION KEYWORD	taught by an expert in a ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"assistants to a master painter in his **workshop**."

12. vases

QUESTION KEYWORD	decoration of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Painting is studied through the designs painted on **vases**."

13. travelers

QUESTION KEYWORD	models bought by ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"replicated in miniature for sale to **travelers**."

Passage 2 — Sleep – Who Needs It?

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14. B — Clifford Saper

QUESTION KEYWORD	brain area sends sleep-regulating signals
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"ventrolateral preoptic nucleus that **sends chemical signals**... and determines the best sleep budget."

15. A — Jerome Siegel

QUESTION KEYWORD	newborns don't sleep normally for weeks
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"for the first month after giving birth, killer whale mothers and their calves **do not experience normal sleep** at all."

16. A — Jerome Siegel

QUESTION KEYWORD	questioned sleep needed for large brain
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a creature which grows one of the **largest brains**... doing this without sleep."

17. C — Verner Bingman

QUESTION KEYWORD	bird drastically reduces sleep
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Swainson's thrushes "go from a normal night's sleep of 10 to 12 hours down to about **2.5 hours**."

18. body temperature

QUESTION KEYWORD	helps regulate their ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"help them keep their **body temperature** constant until... blubber insulation develop."

19. sharks

QUESTION KEYWORD	remain alert to danger of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"mothers of newborn orcas must constantly look out for **sharks**."

20. rats

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ died after two weeks awake
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Two weeks without sleep can kill laboratory **rats**."

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21. closed eyes

QUESTION KEYWORD	near-universal requirement for sleep
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**closed eyes** seem to be a virtually universal prerequisite for sleep."

22. brain

QUESTION KEYWORD	sleep essential only for the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"no more effective than... wakeful resting – except for one critical organ, the **brain**."

23. migration

QUESTION KEYWORD	cut sleep to complete their ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"which for **migration** purposes, go from a normal night's sleep... down to about 2.5 hours so they can fly at night."

24. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	young orcas sleep less than other mammals
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"most other mammals... need extra sleep during infancy... while orcas are **never as active**" — i.e. never sleeping as much — "as in the first months of life."

25. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	scientists certain fish sleep
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"scientists are **unsure** if reptiles and fish do."

26. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	sleep essential for muscle restoration
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	sleep "is **no more effective** than a comparable period of wakeful resting" for muscles — except the brain.

Passage 3 — Looking at Daily Life in Ancient Rome

27. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	what writer says about the period

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"this generation attained the **pinnacle of ancient civilization**" — Rome at its "most powerful and prosperous."

28. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	Ostia mentioned as
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the ruins of Ostia "supply an **immense fund of archaeological evidence**."

29. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	'Fortune has favoured the historian'
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	a "**profusion**" of literary sources (Martial, Juvenal, Pliny) plus archaeological evidence.

30. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	comparing urban and rural life
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a much **greater gulf** separated the peasant from the townsman of antiquity."

31. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	Arabia conquest caused immigration to Rome
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the conquest "helped to bring the **riches** of India and East Asia flooding into Rome" — goods, not people.

32. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	more learned from this period's literature
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"all the more fortunate in that Latin literature was **soon to run nearly dry**" after this generation.

33. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	Herculaneum/Pompeii disproved beliefs
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	only that the ruins "supply an immense fund of archaeological evidence" — no claim of disproving prior beliefs

34. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	peasants helped the Empire when attacked

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the peasants decided to **fight alongside**" the invading barbarian forces, not defend Rome.

35. YES

QUESTION KEYWORD	rural inhabitants had a difficult life
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the peasant knew nothing but **unending labour without profit**."

36. NO

QUESTION KEYWORD	entertainment limited to Rome
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the peasant "was unable to enjoy the activities available in **even the poorest of cities**" — implying such entertainment existed beyond Rome too.

37. I — investigation

QUESTION KEYWORD	limit several aspects of his ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"we must study it within a strictly defined time" — narrowing the scope of the study/investigation.

38. H — period

QUESTION KEYWORD	limited ____ in Roman history
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"this history will confine itself to studying the generation... [a defined] **period**."

39. E — city-dwellers

QUESTION KEYWORD	concentrate on population who were ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"those Roman subjects who spent their time exclusively in the **town**."

40. F — social classes *(printed as given; "values" arguably fits the "moral background" reference slightly better, but the source answer key states F)*

QUESTION KEYWORD	____ contributed to strength/weakness
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the social milieu of the various classes of the hierarchy... the moral background of thought and sentiment which can help explain both its strength and its weaknesses."

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Answer Key & Explanations

Reading Test 6 (Volume 6)

Passage 1 — Ambergris

1. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	very expensive
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Both substances were **rare and costly**."

2. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	food flavouring
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	ambergris "widely used as a spice, which was believed to be an **aphrodisiac when added to food or wine**."

3. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	used as currency
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	neither substance is described as a form of currency anywhere in the passage

4. A

QUESTION KEYWORD	sweet-smelling
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	ambergris is "pleasantly aromatic," while Melville describes amber as "**odorless**."

5. C

QUESTION KEYWORD	referred to by Melville
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Melville's Moby Dick quote distinguishes "**the two substances**" — both ambergris and amber.

6. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	can be seen through
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Melville: amber is "a hard, **transparent**, brittle, odorless substance."

7. beaks

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QUESTION KEYWORD	problems digesting the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"problems the whales have in digesting the **beaks** of such creatures."

8. vomited (up)

QUESTION KEYWORD	black liquid is ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"large quantities of the liquid are **vomited up** by the whale."

9. hardens

QUESTION KEYWORD	liquid ____ on contact with air
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Once outside the whale's body and exposed to air, the substance **hardens**."

10. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	most ambergris from dead whales
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"over 90 per cent of the annual worldwide total was acquired... as a **by-product of commercial whaling**."

11. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	value has increased recently
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the passage never discusses recent changes in ambergris's market value

12. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	remains important in perfume
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"ambergris was **supplanted** in the making of perfume by other materials."

13. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	new uses recently found
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the passage doesn't mention any newly discovered uses

Passage 2 — Photography

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14. B

QUESTION KEYWORD	fears about threat to art
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Baudelaire: photography developing "to the detriment of art" would bring "**loss to human spiritual content**."

15. F

QUESTION KEYWORD	skills of artists used in photography
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"increasing involvement of **people trained as artists**," bringing "concern for form and composition."

16. D

QUESTION KEYWORD	photographers imitating art
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"scratched their prints in an effort to **imitate something of the appearance of a canvas**."

17. G

QUESTION KEYWORD	influence on artists/painting
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"encouraged **Impressionist painters to experiment**... released painting from its responsibility for literal depiction."

18. paintings

QUESTION KEYWORD	pictures similar to ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"produce pictures which in some ways resembled **paintings**."

19. composition

QUESTION KEYWORD	parts of the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"careful arrangement of all the elements of the **composition**."

20. blurred

QUESTION KEYWORD	picture rather ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"ensuring that the image was somewhat **blurred**."

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21. scratched

QUESTION KEYWORD	even ____ their photographs
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"**scratched** their prints in an effort to imitate... a canvas."

22. monochrome

QUESTION KEYWORD	sort of ____ painting
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"did not want to treat the medium as a kind of **monochrome** painting."

23. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	artists' involvement developed photography
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Harker: photography's art "can be partly accounted for through the **increasing involvement of people trained as artists**."

24. NOT GIVEN *(printed as given; the passage's statement that painted portraits "were still commissioned by the wealthy and the aristocracy" arguably supports FALSE rather than NOT GIVEN — flagged as a possible source-key inconsistency)*

QUESTION KEYWORD	portrait painting completely obsolete
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the painted portrait was **still commissioned by the wealthy and the aristocracy**."

25. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	wealthy stopped commissioning
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the painted portrait was **still commissioned** by the wealthy and the aristocracy."

26. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	painting became more experimental
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"released painting from its responsibility for literal depiction, allowing it to become **more experimental**."

Passage 3 — The Long View

27. B — Dr James Canton

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QUESTION KEYWORD	flexible organisations, better position
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Asian companies tend to be **better prepared** because they take a longer perspective."

28. E — Bill Rammell

QUESTION KEYWORD	predictions beyond 10 years untrustworthy
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"assumptions about technology get **very shaky beyond that** [decade]."

29. C — Robin Gunston

QUESTION KEYWORD	only certain people suited
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"I don't believe you can **train yourself** to become a futurist... how your brain is hard-wired."

30. A — Philip Watts

QUESTION KEYWORD	informs commercial decisions
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"designed to challenge our thinking so that we can make **better choices** in today's business world."

31. B — Dr James Canton

QUESTION KEYWORD	broad exchange, not every fad
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"constantly discussing ideas with their peers, but they **do not simply surf the net** picking up on the latest fad."

32. F — Steve Brant

QUESTION KEYWORD	unaware of influence over future
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"We have **much more influence** over what the future will be like than many of us realise."

33. D — Alan Beckley

QUESTION KEYWORD	lack of confidence limits use
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"People are **concerned about the methodology and the reliability** of future studies."

34. energy

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QUESTION KEYWORD	impact of kinds of ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"how people may live in 2020 and 2050, given the type of **energy** which is purchased."

35. economic competition

QUESTION KEYWORD	advise on ____ from Asia/Europe
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"demographics and **economic competition** within Europe and with Asia."

36. private sector

QUESTION KEYWORD	began career in the ____
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Like many futurists he started in the **private sector**."

37. demographics

QUESTION KEYWORD	studies ____ beyond 10 years
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"occasionally look further ahead than the next ten years on issues such as **demographics**."

38., 39. & 40. A, D & G

QUESTION KEYWORD	which three statements are true
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	[A] "start with a desired result and work out how..."; [D] Canton "work[s] with people from a range of academic backgrounds"; [G] "winners will be those corporations... which **conduct future studies**."

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